Grisbi Manual

Personal accounting software

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Contents

List of Figures iv

1 Preamble 1
- 1.1 Forward to the English Translation . . . 1
- 1.2 Why refer to it as Grisbi? . . . 2
- 1.3 Bibliography . . . 4
- 1.4 Filmography . . . 4

2 Introduction 7
- 2.1 General . . . 7
- 2.2 Features . . . 7
  - 2.2.1 What Grisbi knows how to do . . . 7
  - 2.2.2 What Grisbi does not know yet . . . 8
- 2.3 Software Evolution . . . 8
  - 2.3.1 Development and versions . . . 8
  - 2.3.2 Version 0.1 (10/04/2000) . . . 9
  - 2.3.3 Version 0.2 (19/06/2000) . . . 9
  - 2.3.4 From version 0.3.0 (10/12/2001) to version 0.3.3 (15/11/2002) . . . 9
  - 2.3.5 From version 0.4.0 (15/02/2003) to version 0.4.4 (25/03/2004) . . . 10
  - 2.3.6 From version 0.4.5 (07/04/2004) to version 0.6 (05/05/2010) . . . 11
  - 2.3.7 What's new in version 0.8 (21/02/2011) . . . 11
  - 2.3.8 What's new in version 1.0 (17/03/2014) . . . 12
  - 2.3.9 What's new in version 2.0 (11/01/2021) . . . 12
  - 2.3.10 What's new in version 3.0 (13/11/2023) . . . 13
  - 2.3.11 And for the future? . . . 13
- 2.4 Contacts . . . 13
- 2.5 Authors and contributors . . . 13
- 2.6 Acknowledgments . . . 14
- 2.7 Licenses . . . 14
- 2.8 About this manual . . . 15
  - 2.8.1 Introduction . . . 15
  - 2.8.2 Typographical conventions of this manual . . . 16
  - 2.8.3 Reading software . . . 17

3 Initial set-up of Grisbi 18
- 3.1 Initial Set-up Wizard . . . 18
- 3.2 Example file . . . 19
- 3.3 Creation of a new accounts file . . . 19
- 3.4 Saving your accounts file . . . 23
- 3.5 Import from other personal accounting software . . . 23

4 Entering Grisbi 24
- 4.1 Selecting a file . . . 24

4.2 Homepage . . . 25
4.3 Information bar . . . 26
4.4 Navigation panel . . . 26
4.5 Details panel . . . 27
4.5.1 Displaying details on the home page . . . 28
4.6 Menu bar . . . 29
4.6.1 *File* menu . . . 30
4.6.2 *Edit* menu . . . 31
4.6.3 *View* menu . . . 31
4.6.4 *Help* menu . . . 32
4.7 Shortcut keys . . . 33
4.7.1 Application and files . . . 33
4.7.2 Navigation panel . . . 33
4.7.3 List of transactions or scheduled transactions . . . 33
4.7.4 Transaction/Scheduled form . . . 34
4.7.5 Drop down lists . . . 34
4.7.6 Dates entered on the calendar . . . 35
4.7.7 Dates entered by keyboard . . . 35
4.7.8 Payees, categories, budgetary lines, credits simulator, historical data and forecast . . . 35
4.7.9 Configuration . . . 35
4.7.10 Help . . . 35

5 Importing and exporting accounts 36
5.1 Importing accounts from another accounting application . . . 36
5.1.1 Export an account file from the other accounting application . . . 36
5.1.2 Importing account files from another accounting application to Grisbi . 36
5.2 Export accounts from Grisbi . . . 40

6 Data management 42
6.1 Account files handling . . . 42
6.2 Backups . . . 42
6.3 Archiving . . . 43
6.3.1 Creating an archive . . . 43
6.3.2 Displaying archives . . . 45
6.3.3 Parameters of an archive . . . 46
6.3.4 Editing an archive . . . 46
6.3.5 Deleting an archive . . . 46
6.3.6 Export an archive . . . 46

7 Account management 47
7.1 List of accounts . . . 47
7.2 Selecting an account . . . 47
7.3 Account properties . . . 48
7.4 Creating a new account . . . 50
7.5 Editing an account . . . 52
7.6 Closing an account . . . 53
7.7 Deleting an account . . . 53
7.8 Types of Grisbi accounts . . . 53
7.8.1 Type *bank account* . . . 54

7.8.2 Type *cash account* . . . 57
7.8.3 Type *liability account* . . . 57
7.8.4 Type *asset account* . . . 58

8 Account transactions **60**
8.1 Toolbar . . . 61
8.2 List of transactions . . . 61
8.2.1 Description . . . 61
8.2.2 Information and input fields . . . 62
8.2.3 Management of information fields . . . 63
8.2.4 Sorts . . . 64
8.3 Transaction/Scheduled entry form . . . 65
8.3.1 Form visibility . . . 65
8.3.2 Form contents . . . 66
8.4 Pointed balance . . . 67
8.5 Selecting an transaction . . . 67
8.6 Entering a new transaction . . . 68
8.6.1 Entering information . . . 68
8.6.2 Main keyboard commands . . . 68
8.6.3 Entering the date using the keyboard . . . 68
8.6.4 Entering a date in the calendar . . . 69
8.6.5 Drop-down lists . . . 69
8.6.6 Entering formulas . . . 69
8.6.7 Depositing cheques or cash . . . 70
8.6.8 Transfers . . . 70
8.6.9 Advances: consent and receipt . . . 72
8.6.10 Automatic form completion . . . 72
8.7 Entering a currency transaction . . . 72
8.8 Entering a transaction with a virtual third party . . . 74
8.9 Breakdown of a transaction . . . 74
8.9.1 Entering the breaken-down transaction . . . 74
8.9.2 Entering split sub-transactions . . . 75
8.9.3 Validation of the split transaction . . . 76
8.9.4 Displaying the split transaction . . . 76
8.9.5 Automatic completion of the form for a split transaction . . . 76
8.10 Editing an transaction . . . 77
8.11 Deleting a transaction . . . 78
8.12 Transaction selected as a template . . . 78
8.13 Cloning a transaction . . . 78
8.14 Converting a transaction into a scheduled transaction . . . 79
8.15 Moving a transaction to another account . . . 79
8.16 New payee, category or budgetary line . . . 79
8.17 Printing the list of transactions . . . 79

Index **81**

Glossary **84**

List of Figures

3.1 Initial configuration of accounts file. 18
3.2 General configuration of a accounts file 20
3.3 Selection of categories to be used 21
3.4 Choices when creating the first account 22

4.1 Start-up window 24
4.2 Accounts summary page 25
4.3 Navigation panel 26
4.4 Modified details panel 28
4.5 *File* menu 30
4.6 *Edit* menu 31
4.7 *View* Menu 32
4.8 *Help* menu 32

5.1 Selecting accounts to import 37
5.2 Configuring the import of a CSV file 38
5.3 Configuration of each imported account 39
5.4 Exporting accounts 40

6.1 Creating an archive 44
6.2 Archive line displayed 45

7.1 Account *Properties* tab 48
7.2 Choice of new account type 50
7.3 New account settings 51
7.4 Entering the name of the new account 52

8.1 The *Transactions* tab of an account 60
8.2 Customised transaction entry form 65
8.3 Context menu for an transaction 67
8.4 Calendar 69
8.5 Fees and exchange rates 73
8.6 Entering the split transaction 75
8.7 Entering the first split sub-transaction 75
8.8 Entering the second split sub-transaction 75
8.9 Entering the third split sub-transaction 76
8.10 Split transaction in the list of transactions 76
8.11 Full view of the split transaction 76

1 Preamble

1.1 Forward to the English Translation

Manual version 3.0 corresponds to software version 3.0.
The English version is a combination of the revision of English version 1.0 and the translation of French version 3.0.

It was started by Bob Anderson[1] with the version 1.0 in order to give a little back to the *Free and Open Source Software* (FOSS) Community. He had no particular financial or linguistic skills, but as a long-standing user of the software and managing without the help of the manual, he knew how necessary this translation was.

This translation is word for word. It is important to keep to this format to make it easier to add changes to the English translation of the original French manual. You may also see a short paragraph or footnote with the note **Translators Note:**. If a new paragraph or footnote is added to explain a problem with the translation, or to flag a section that needs revision in both the French and English versions, it must be done in a way that ensures the French and English versions are exactly the same. This means that any changes to the English version will only be made **after** the French version is accepted.

The translation from the French Manual starts on the next page

The translation from the French manual begins with the title of the next section, **Why refer to it as Grisbi?**, which has been modified by Bob Anderson from the original title, **Etymology**. This section includes the original author Daniel Cartron's commentary on the etymology of the word *grisbi*.

Bob Anderson provides a cautionary note regarding his translation efforts. He has endeavoured to maintain the denotation and connotation of the French dictionary entries. While the majority of the words have been translated into English, the accuracy of these translations should not be relied upon, except to provide a general impression of the original French text. For those with a keen interest in etymology, it would be beneficial to consult the original French version of this manual section.

[1] www23@scilutions.co.uk

1.2 Why refer to it as Grisbi?

Several Grisbi users have asked Daniel Cartron, the editor of the first version of the manual, to insert a brief reminder of the meaning of this word, which, to his chagrin, fell back into disuse.

His first (brief) research did not bring him any results worth publishing, He had then dropped it until one day he had the opportunity to spend some time in a well-stocked library containing dictionaries of all kinds, there the harvest was abundant. It was so abundant that Daniel Cartron hesitated a long time to know what he was going to keep and what he was going to eliminate . . . Finally he decided to keep everything, even if we go from a paragraph to four pages. He just made a compilation of the shortest items to the longest ones. Indeed he find it interesting to study the differences between the different dictionaries, but even more to note the similarities, at this point striking that one could title this chapter not *The game of the seven errors* but *Who copied who?* It's up to you to find. . . And he also added a passage on the film because for those who still know what grisbi means is essentially due to the deserved reputation of this work.

Here are some sources on the etymology of the word grisbi:

Dictionary of French language — Hachette

[grizbi] n. m. Slang. Silver — Of grey (grey money, cd rouchi griset [1834], "liard"), and suff. pop. -bi; 1895, spread in 1953.

Grand Larousse of the French language

[grizbi] n. m. (of *grey [and]*, piece of six liards [1834, Esnault] — der. from *grey*, because of the color [cf. also *grisette*, "coin" — 17th century. —, and *white and grey coin*, 1784, Esnault] — with the suffix.slang. *-bi*; 1896, Delesalle). *Slang*. Money: *Do not touch the grisbi* (title of a novel by Albert Simonin [1953]).

Historical Dictionary of the French language — Robert

n.m. appeared in 1895 (*grisbis*) and spread from 1953 by the novel *Do not touch the grisbi* by A. Simonin, would be composed of *gris* "grey money" (1784: see le rouchi *griset* "six-liard coin", 1834, and *grisette* "coin", v. 1634) and the *bi* element of obscure origin: *grisbi*, "silver" in slang, could be a tautological compound of *grey* and *bis*.

Dictionary of French slang and its origins — Larousse

Very controversial origin: either of griset, "coin", and a mysterious suffix -bi, or bread both grey and bis, or English slang crispy, silver; we propose to see a metonymic use of gripis 1628 [Cheneau], grispin, grisbis 1849 [Halbert], "meunier", that is to say, "one who has at his home wheat" 1895 [Delsalle] but reintroduced by "Touch the grisbi", famous novel of A. Simonin, published in 1953.

VARIANTS — grijbi: 1902 [Esnault] — grèzbi: around 1926 [id.]

DERIVATIVES — grisbinette n.f. One hundred old franc coins: 1957 [Sandry-Carrère].

Treasures of the French language

Slang. Silver. Synon. pop. *money, cake, pèze, cash. The grisbi I'm big enough to pick it myself! (. . .) Riton who had not even known how to behave like a man (. . .) as soon as he felt enough*

grisbi (Simonin, *Touch not to the grisbi*, 1953, p 231). **Pronunciation**: [grizbi]. **Étymol. and Hist.** 1896 *grisbis* slang. "money" (Delesalle, *French-Slang and Slang-French Dict.*). Word composed of rad. of *griset*, in the sense of this six-liard piece" (1834 ds Esn.), der. of *grey*, because of the color (*cf.* also *ca* 1634 *grisette* "coin", *The Norman Muse* by D. Ferrand , Ed A. Heron, II, 91, 1784, Brest, *white and grey coin* in Esn., and a second part of obscure origin which represents maybe the suff. pop. -bi, to be close to *nerbi* "very black" (from Esn.). It is not impossible that *grisbi* (formerly *grisbis*) is a tautological compound of *grey* and *bis*.

Bbg. Rigaud (A.). L'arg. litt. *Life lang.* 1972, pp. 114-117.

Grand Robert of the French language

[grizbi] n. m. — 1895: spread 1953 by Simonin's novel *Touch not to grisbi*; the word was rare or archaic v. 1950: from *grey* "grey money" (see rouchi *griset* "liard", 1834), and suff. pop. **Slang** Money. *T'as du grisbi?*

1 — This expression: "Do not touch the grisbi" becomes a variation of "Do not mess with the nippes". This is the keyword that leads the chronicle of these knights of ill-gotten fortune who gave mobility to Peter Cheyney's cape and machine gun novels. Pierre Mac Orlan, *in* Albert Simonin, Do not touch the grisbi, Preface, p. 6.

2 — "Forget bein' nice, fam... We ain't got time if you need me to track down Ali. It all boils down to how much grisbi (crispy) he's stacking in his pockets. If he's packing, there's a shot at spotting him at the casino, at the Carillon joint"

Albert Simonin, do not touch the grisbi, p. 147.

Dictionary of Unconventional French — Hachette

n.m. (Grisby)

Silver (intrinsically).

"To the little kingpin of the team, a kid in a torpedo cap, blue overalls and patent leather pumps, the little girl had just said she was watching only for the right motive, to relieve me of my hundred notes. He had replicated, the naughty jealousy: "The *grisbi*, I'm big enough to pick it up myself!" They were both right, both equally ready to do anything for the *grisbi* (loot). They and their little friends. Like Angelo-la-Tante and Josy-la-Peau-de-Vache; like Ali-le-Fumier and his garbage of espingos; like Riton, who hadn't even known how to behave like a man with his brat, as soon as he felt he had enough *grisbi*; like Marco and his little Wanda, so honest, but who didn't hesitate to be stepped over by the *grisbi*! like also the young Lulu, no doubt, who waited patiently at home for me to come back, with my *grisbi*"

A. Simonin, Do not touch the grisbi, p. 233

HIST. — 1895, but probably little used: A. Bruant and L. Blédort, who occasionally accumulate synonyms (*weigh, bone,*, etc.), do not use *grisbi*, although Bruant records it in 1901 (*grisbis*). The deserved success of A. Simonin's novel in 1953 gave a new lease of life to the word, which nevertheless does not seem to be truly integrated into the series of designations of money, such as *wheat, sorrel, flouze* or *fric*.

Rouchi *griset*, "a six-liard piece" (1834), so called because of its color. But the only explanation currently available given by Esnault, is not satisfactory; on the one hand, the element *bi* remains unexplained, if not by a "suffix" unknown; on the other hand, Bruant writes *grisbis*, and it is possible (if not probable) that the central *s* pronounced only since 1953; which would lead to an explanation: *gris-bis*, in the series of alternative words for bread, *wheat, carmine, biscuit, pancake*, etc.

Finally, if the *metonymy*[1] of colour is actually used to denominate money, it is always a precise category of money: "cash". Thus *jaunet, white, white, copper*, are not interchangeable nor usable for "money" abstract.

We would also point out the meaning of *gris*: "expensive" (V. *grisol*) and the possibility of the augmentative pseudo-suffix *bi*, "très", even rare. We would then have: *gris-bi*, "very expensive"? But the hypothesis is adventurous.

1.3 Bibliography

Touchez pas au grisbi! by Albert Simonin, published in 1953

- Gallimard, Collection Série Noire No. 148, first edition in 1953
- Le Livre de Poche No. 1152, first edition in 1953
- Gallimard, Collection Carré Noir No. 94, first edition in 1972
- Gallimard, Collection Folio No. 2068, first edition in 1989
- Gallimard, Collection Folio Policier No. 183, first edition in 1953, reissued in 2014 (always edited)

1.4 Filmography

Touchez pas au grisbi (French for **Don't touch the loot**), released as **Honour Among Thieves** in the United Kingdom and **Grisbi** in the United States

French-Italian film (1954). Gangster-film genre. Duration: 1h 34 min

Original title: Grisbi

Distribution:

- Jean Gabin: Max the liar
- Rene Dary: Riton
- Dora Doll: Lola
- Vittorio Sanipoli: Ramon
- Marilyn Buferd: Betty
- Gaby Basset: Marinette
- Paul Barge: Eugene

Director: Jacques Becker

Synopsis

Max-the-liar and Riton have just pulled off the greatest heist of their lives: stealing 50 million francs worth of gold bars at Orly. With this "grisbi", both gangsters expect to enjoy a peaceful retirement. But Riton can not resist telling his mistress Josy about money. The younger burlesque-dancer girlfriend passes the valuable information to Angelo, a drug dealer with whom she is cheating on Riton with. Angelo kidnaps the old mobster and demands "grisbi" from Max as ransom . . .

[1] https://literarydevices.net/metonymy/

Trivia

A well-oiled tandem: Jean GABIN and René DARY are considered two sacred figures of cinema before the war.

BECKER father and son: Jacques' son BECKER, Jean, makes his film debut here as an assistant director. He is only fifteen years old!

Albert SIMONIN: Writer and screenplay by Albert SIMONIN, who here adapts his own novel, will make four more movies with GABIN, all dialogues by AUDIARD: *Le cave se rebiffe* (1961) and *The gentleman of Epsom* (1962) by Gilles GRANGIER, *Mélodie en sous-sol* (1963) by Henri VERNEUIL and *The Pasha* (1967) by Georges LAUTNER. After adapting his *Les Tontons flingueurs* for Georges LAUTNER (1963), he became his screenwriter for *Les Barbouzes* (1964).

Zone 2 DVD version

- Interactivity: Home menu, access to scenes, filmographies drop-downs from the director, from Lino VENTURA and John Gabin
- Cinema format: full screen
- Sound version: French in mono
- Subtitles: none
- France — 1954 — Black & white
- Length: 92 min — 1 disc — 1 side — 1 layer
- Release date: September 19, 2001
- Publisher: Studio Canal

Zone 2 Blu-ray version

- Cinema format: 4/3 respected format 1.33
- Sound version: French in stéréo
- France — 1954 — Black & white — 94 min
- Subtitles: none
- Release date: March 10, 2017
- Publisher: Studio Canal

Zone 1 DVD / Blu-ray versions

- Cinema format: 4/3 respected format 1.33
- Sound version: French in stéréo
- France — 1954 — Black & white — 94 min
- Subtitles: English
- Release date: 21 Aug. 2017

- Publisher: Studio Canal

The zone 1 versions have English subtitles and include interviews with filmmaker Jean Becker and actress Jeanne Moreau.

2 Introduction

2.1 General

Grisbi is a free accounting program, developed in the C language with support for GTK+ 3, originally for the GNU/Linux platform. There is now a porting on Windows, macOS, FreeBSD, packages for different Linux distributions, and other possibilities to discover on *Grisbi*[1] or *Sourceforge*[2].

The basic principle is to allow you to classify in a simple and intuitive way your financial operations, whatever they are, in order to be able to exploit them in the best way according to your needs.

Grisbi emphasises simplicity and efficiency, without excluding the sophistication needed by more advanced users. Future features will always try to meet these criteria.

2.2 Features

Translators Note: In this translation, the French word “Tiers” in general has been replaced by the English word "Payees", however the French version of Grisbi also caters for small business use. In the French version any third party i.e. a creditor or debtor could be implied by the word “Tiers”.

Note: French business accounting rules may be incompatible with the rules of any English speaking territories, Grisbi should be used **only** for personal financial record keeping outside of France.

2.2.1 What Grisbi knows how to do

- Software developed by French programmers, so in full compliance with the logic of French accounting
- Simple and intuitive interface, with full-screen display control
- Multi-account and multi-user management
- Local Settings Management (Dates, Decimal Separators and Thousands)
- Bank accounts, cash, assets and liabilities
- Multi-currency management, with support for exchange rates and exchange fees
- Credit card management (immediate or deferred debit)
- Description of transactions with: date, valuation date, fiscal year, Payee amount, currency, category and sub-category, budget allocation and sub-allocation (for analysis of expenditure), note, entry number (assigned by Grisbi), part number, account number, bank reference

[1] https://en.grisbi.org
[2] https://sourceforge.net/projects/grisbi/files/

- Budget classifications and attribution with automatic recall of operations and sub-operations for a given Payee
- Clear Credit and Flow fields option for auto-complete
- Calculation of the balance according to the date of the transaction or its valuation date
- Transfer between accounts, including different currencies, with automatic cross posting
- Scheduling operations with automatic or manual validation
- Deadline monitoring
- Moving and Cloning Operations
- Cloning scheduled operations
- Shading of different periods in the scheduler
- Analysis and financial reports thanks to the powerful report templates module
- Several pre-formatted report templates available and customizable
- Virtuals Payees created by reports
- Printing of reports
- Simulation of loans and depreciation tables with printing and data export
- Estimated budget with charts on forecasts and historical data
- Business Accounting with Chart of Accounts (for French Accounting)
- Account order by drag and drop in the account list
- Import files in the following formats: QIF, OFX, Gnucash or CSV
- Importing category files into budget allocations
- Export files in the QIF or CSV formats
- Choice of custom icons for your different accounts
- Icons in the SVG formats
- Even more context menus on the right mouse button (navigation pane)
- Numerous keyboard shortcuts for good ergonomics

2.2.2 What Grisbi does not know yet

- Automatic breakdown of loan repayments
- Internet reconciliation

2.3 Software Evolution

2.3.1 Development and versions

Grisbi is software in active development, any feedback (idea, bug, documentation. . .) is welcome. You can send it to the relevant lists referenced in the 2.4 on page 13 *Contacts* section or on the *Grisbi*[1] site.

[1] https://en.grisbi.org

If you're feeling adventurous, you can download and compile the latest version being under development on the content management system GitHub[1] using Git.

Indeed, the code of a new versions of Grisbi is typically frozen several weeks before its final release, in order to allow the development team time to check and eradicate the latest bugs. During this period, the format of the account file no longer changes, and you can, with a minimum of precautions (frequent backups, etc.), benefit from the latest improvements several weeks in advance, and also participate in debugging.

Finally, you can access all changes to the code since version 0.3.2 (the version from which the code is available on the GitHub[1] website).

Note that as of version 0.6, even numbered minor number versions (e.g. 0. 8) are stable versions, whereas odd number minor number versions are unstable and should not be used under normal conditions; therefore only stable versions are mentioned here.

2.3.2 Version 0.1 (10/04/2000)

- Management of several accounts
- Creation, modification and deletion of accounts and transactions (the minimum required to operate . . .)
- Possibility of pointing operations
- And backup, without which none of this would be very useful!

2.3.3 Version 0.2 (19/06/2000)

- Automatic import of account files from previous versions
- Use of lists for third parties and categories . . . (more practical than typing everything)
- Automatic entry when typing and filling in of the end of the transaction like the previous version
- Management of transfers between accounts
- Simplified or full display of transactions
- Account balancing

2.3.4 From version 0.3.0 (10/12/2001) to version 0.3.3 (15/11/2002)

- Management of planned or cyclical operations (schedule)
- Support for currencies and the changeover to the euro (from 1 January 1999 to 1 January 2002)
- Import/export added and file import improved QIF
- Added breakdown
- Multi-user support
- For each bank and account, added details such as:
  - full numbers of the associated account, branch and bank code
  - different holder for each account with home address

[1] https://github.com/grisbi/grisbi/

  - contact details for a correspondent
- Categories tab added
- Ability to change currency names and codes
- Alphabetical sorting now (finally) takes accents into account
- Memorises the last working directory and the last files opened
- A single number per transaction, whatever the account
- [+] ([-]) in a date field increment (decrement) the date
- New fields can be displayed in the transaction entry form
- Deadlines can be set for a defined period of time
- Display of the current balance
- Possibility of entering the date in the form ddmm, ddmmyyy or ddmmyyyy
- Transaction totals in the Payees, Categories and Budget Allocations tabs
- The logo and display font can be customised
- Automake and Autoconf tools to simplify compilation of software source files

2.3.5 From version 0.4.0 (15/02/2003) to version 0.4.4 (25/03/2004)

- Customisable interface layout
- Import/export capability:
  - lists of categories
  - lists of budget items
  - created reports
- Financial reports added
- Grisbi is now internationalised and translations have been improved
- Display of multi-currency balances in the start-up screen
- Remarks can now be displayed in the schedule
- New tool to allow contributors to anonymise Grisbi files to maintain confidentiality before submission
- The width of the columns in the schedule can be modified
- Harmonisation of date fields:
  - [Ctrl]+[Enter ↵] in a date field opens a calendar
  - the arrow keys are active in a calendar
  - [Ctrl]+[+] ([Ctrl]+[-]) in a date field increases (decreases) the date by approximately one week
  - [Pg.Up] ([Pg.Dn]) increases (decreases) the date by approximately one month
  - [Ctrl]+[Pg.Up] ([Ctrl]+[Pg.Dn]) increases (decreases) the date by approximately one year

2.3.6 From version 0.4.5 (07/04/2004) to version 0.6 (05/05/2010)

- Revamped GUI
- GTK+ 2 library support for a nicer environment and simplified porting on Windows
- No more dependencies on Gnome
- Native Windows version (thanks to François Terrot)
- Native UTF-8 support
- Printing reports by LaTeX
- Export reports in HTML
- Improved user interface:
  - message enhancement, users can select "ignore"
  - improved management of segmentation errors
  - improvement of the preferences window
  - pop-up menu on the list of operations
  - improving items
- Completely clickable list of accounts with summaries
- Global configuration in XML (thanks to Axel Rousseau)
- Rewrite of the file import:
  - support for the QIF, OFX, Gnucash or CSV formats
  - incremental import
  - automatic reconciliation
- Beginning of the Italian translation by Giorgio Mandolfo
- Hidden exchange rates on a session to avoid re-entering them
- Support for text attributes (bold, italic, large, small) for states
- New logo with mascot Grisbi on a Euro sign (€) (thanks to André Pascual)
- Editable animated waiting logo
- Completely case-sensitive lists of characters
- Improved entry of bank details
- Keyboard support in the tree structure of payees, categories and budget charges
- Automatic clickable term maturities
- Breakdown of maturities
- Transactions convertible into maturities
- Transactions that can be moved to another account

2.3.7 What's new in version 0.8 (21/02/2011)

- Budget module in the basic version
- Credit simulator and amortization tables with the possibility to print and export the data in a spreadsheet

- Amortization table for liability accounts with the ability to print and export data in a spreadsheet
- Local Settings Management (Date Format, Decimal Separators and Thousands)
- Embedding custom icons in the accounts file
- Shading of different periods in the scheduler
- Cloning scheduled operations

2.3.8 What's new in version 1.0 (17/03/2014)

- Graphics on forecasts
- Credit card management (immediate or deferred debit)
- Business accounting with a Chart of Accounts
- Grisbi icon in the SVG formats
- Even more context menus on the right mouse button
- Importing category files into budget allocations
- Changing the account display order by drag and drop in the account list
- Calculation of the balance according to the date of the transaction or its valuation date
- Option to delete credit and debit fields for auto-completion
- View unused payees
- Full-screen display command by function key F11
- Keyboard shortcut Ctrl + T for the call of a new operation
- Direct access to the user manual through the menu *Help* or the keyboard shortcut Ctrl + H

2.3.9 What's new in version 2.0 (11/01/2021)

- Ported to GTK+ 3 (since version 1.2.0)
- Addition of a search module in the list of accessible operations, in the operations context menu (right-click on an operation)
- Automatic detection/integration of dark schematics
- New colour settings
- General font size configuration
- Improved display on low-resolution devices
- Revised credit module
- Import rules for CVS files
- Search functionality
- Setting for deleting old backups
- Bug fixes

2.3.10 What's new in version 3.0 (13/11/2023)

- Modification of the beneficiary search
- Addition of a new type of consumer loan
- All transactions added to archives when account is closed
- Code clean-up
- Preparing the transition to GTK 4
- Bug fixes

2.3.11 And for the future?

Full port under GTK 4

2.4 Contacts

In addition to emailing the authors, you have several mailing lists you can contact us or obtain information through.

To keep abreast of developments in Grisbi, you can register on the *Information list*[1] provided for this purpose. You will then receive an email at the release of each new version.

If you'd like to get involved in Grisbi's development, there's a *development list*[2].

We've also decided to take Grisbi international, and if you'd like to help us, you can get in touch with us on the development list.

To subscribe to one of these lists, simply go to the `https://listes.grisbi.org/mailman/listinfo` page and click on the list(s) you are interested in.

You can also use the discussion forums (or newsgroups) with a program called "news reader" (like Thunderbird for example) by entering `listes.grisbi.org` as the group server name.

In addition do not hesitate to regularly consult Grisbi's official website.

2.5 Authors and contributors

Cédric Auger is the basis of the project.

Daniel Cartron wrote the documentation up to version 0.4.0, provided accounting advice and ergonomics, and created the first Grisbi site. His passion for ultra-compliant accounts files brings an undeniable bonus to the discovery of unpublished bugs.

André Pascual, from *Linuxgraphic*[3], is the author of the first logo (Grisbi mascot on the euro symbol €).

Sébastien Blondeel wrote the scripts used to produce the various documentation formats and those for converting images to the appropriate formats. He is also responsible for the adoption of LaTeX for writing the documentation. In addition, his experience of electronic publishing makes him a valuable adviser and source of many suggestions.

Benjamin Drieu, developer for Grisbi and official packager for Debian.

[1] `info@listes.grisbi.org`
[2] `devel@listes.grisbi.org`
[3] `https://www.linuxgraphic.org`

Alain Portal, who was starting to get bored in Red Hat packaging. His love of a job well done and his obstinacy make him, for the moment, a bug fixer. He also participates in the compilation of the documentation. He wants to start coding in the unstable version.

Loic Breilloux has updated the documentation for version 0.5.1 and will try to update the documentation for future releases.

Gerald Niel replaced Daniel Cartron in the role of webmaster and is therefore the creator of the new version of *Grisbi*[1]. He is also responsible for Slackware packages.

Juliette Martin has the thankless task of proofreading of the documentation. If there are any mistakes, it's certainly they were well hidden for escaping his attentive eyes

François Terrot[2] joined the team to create Grisbi's porting for Windows.

Pierre Biava[3] joined the development team in 2008.

DidierChevalier[4],William Ollivier[5] and Mickael Remars have also participated in development.

Jean-Luc Duflot[6] made a big update of the manual for the 0.6 version, which was needed since 2004, and continued on with the 0.8 and the 1.0 versions too.

Alain Letient[7] tenaciously re-read the 0.6 manual and created its iconography, and also continued with versions 0.8 and 1.0.

Guy Lebègue, first for version 0.8, then with MichèleBondil[8] for 1.0, created the business accounting option, which requires many specialist accounting skills.

2.6 Acknowledgments

Thanks to *TuxFamily*[9] who has long made available to us all the tools we needed to develop Grisbi (website, ftp, CVS, mailing lists, etc.). Alas, the attacks inflicted by hackers in late 2003 - early 2004 on *TuxFamily* have forced us to seek a new web home. So today we thank *SourceForge*[10], the platform to which we migrated. We wish a quick and quick recovery to *TuxFamily* that is sorely lacking hundreds of free projects.

A big thank you also to all the contributors on the development list who helped Grisbi's evolution through their suggestions, remarks and bug reports, as well as to the many readers of the *User Manual*, which contribute to make it a better tool.

2.7 Licenses

The program is subject to the terms of the *GNU General Public License*. Bug fixes and updates are not guaranteed.

The manual is subject to the terms of the *GNU Free Documentation License*.

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[9] https://www.tuxfamily.org/en/main
[10] https://sourceforge.net/projects/grisbi/files/

2.8 About this manual

You are looking at version 3.0 of the manual, dated early 2025, which corresponds to version 3.0 of the Grisbi software.

Note: this version 3.0 of the manual is a mixture of an update of the English version 1.0 and a translation of the French version 3.0.

This manual was written using the text editor LaTeX, and is available in file format PDF or HTML, with illustrations (screenshots) in both formats.

It can be accessed directly in the Grisbi software via the *Help - Manual* menu on the menu bar or by the F1 shortcut.

All these different formats can also be downloaded from the *Sourceforge*[1] site, as well as the corresponding versions of the software on *Sourceforge*[2] in the "grisbi stable" or "grisbi unstable" folders.

The tools needed to read the various manual formats are presented in the 2.8.3 on page 17 section *Reading software*.

2.8.1 Introduction

Although Grisbi is designed to be as intuitive as possible and most functions are immediately understandable, a reference manual is needed. This manual has been designed according to the following principles:

- the most comprehensive possible, covering all the program features;
- chapters organised according to a framework that is as standardised as possible:
  - presentation of the chapter
  - description of the display
  - description of the functions

  to help you find your way around the document
- paragraphs that recur from one chapter to the next are written in as identical a manner as possible, to make them easier to read quickly
- easy to find information thanks to numerous hyperlinks, an index and a glossary.

Here is a brief description of the different chapters:

- *Preamble* Introduces the English translation and explains the origin of the name given to this software;
- *Introduction* Introduces the software, the manual, their authors and contacts;
- *First start Grisbi* is the *essential* chapter to help you to start using the software;

[1] https://sourceforge.net/projects/grisbi/files/Documentation/
[2] https://sourceforge.net/projects/grisbi/files/

- *Home* describes the main elements of the GUI and their manipulation with the mouse and the keyboard (shortcuts);
- *Export and Import Accounts* describes how to exchange data with other software;
- *Data Management* presents the options of the account files, backups and archives and their management;
- *Accounts Management* describes the properties of accounts, their management and the different types of accounts with their use;
- *Account Operations* describes how transactions are handled, the information and input fields used and how they are managed, and how transactions are created and managed;
- *Bank Reconciliation* details the procedure for reconciling an account and managing reconciliations;
- *Schedule* describes the planning of future entries and their manipulation;
- *Searches* takes stock of data search possibilities;
- *Payees*, *Categories*, *budgetary allocations* and *Exercises* describe the management of this data;
- *Credit Simulation* describes methods and simulation management;
- *Forecast Budgets* describes the tools and procedures for budget creation and depreciation tables, as well as their management;
- *Credit card management and their prediction* describes the management of these cards, including deferred debit cards, and forecasting methods;
- *Business Accounting* presents two introductions for business managers (for French only)
- *Reports* and *Report creation* describe the management and creation of reports;
- *Configuration of Grisbi* details all the possibilities of setting the software;
- *Maintenance Tools* gives some tips to use in case of errors or bugs.

2.8.2 Typographical conventions of this manual

The following list defines and illustrates the typographic conventions used as visual aids for identifying particular elements of the text of the document:

- the interface components are window titles, icon and button names, menu names, and other options that appear on the screen; they are presented as follows:
  click *Back*
- the keyboard key label represents what is written on the keyboard keys; it is presented as follows:
  press Enter ↵;
- key combinations are a series of keys to be pressed simultaneously (unless otherwise specified) to perform a single function; they are presented as follows:
  press the combination Ctrl + R
- The commands that are part of an instruction and that must be entered are presented as follows:
  type `grisbi` to start the program

- file and directory names are shown as:
  grisbi-n.n.n.rpm and **/usr/local/bin**
- the command lines consist of a command and can include one or more possible parameters of the command; they are presented as follows:
  `rpm -Uvh grisbi-n.n.n.rpm`
- any sequence of alphanumeric characters in blue, in the document in PDF or HTML format, is a hypertext link, referring to either an image, another part of the document, an indexed word or to the glossary (for PDF only);
- The words or groups of words referenced in the index are highlighted in the chapters as follows:
  - referenced term for PDF format
  - in brown for HTML
- **Note**: underlines a particular point to be taken into account
- **WARNING**: indicates either a point that is very important for understanding, or an error that must not be made on pain of serious damage to your data;
  WARNING indicates a point that *must be respected*.

2.8.3 Reading software

To read this document, we recommend the use of free software, which respects all your privacy and the confidentiality of your data; the following software has the features of hyperlinks:

- for the PDF format:
  - Linux: Evince, Firefox, Xpdf, Ghostscript*, MuPDF*, Okular
  - Mac: Okular, Skim, Xpdf
  - Windows: Evince, Firefox, MuPDF*, Okular, SumatraPdf

  * Software that does not display the table of contents in a side panel.
- for the HTML format:
  - Linux: Firefox, Falcon, Links2, Midori, Dillo, SeaMonkey, NetSurf, Min
  - Mac: Firefox, Falcon, Midori, SeaMonkey, NetSurf
  - Windows: Firefox, Falcon, Midori, SeaMonkey, NetSurf

In short, you have the choice!

These software packages can all be downloaded from their own websites and are all licensed as free software, and you can read about some of them on the *Free Software Directory*[1] or French *Framasoft*[2] websites

[1] https://directory.fsf.org/wiki/Main_Page
[2] https://framalibre.org/

3 Initial set-up of Grisbi

3.1 Initial Set-up Wizard

After installing Grisbi, the first time the software is launched, it will help you with three consecutive wizards:

1. The first wizard "Welcome to Grisbi!", which will only appear once, on first launch, helps you configure the application. It comprises two steps, the second of which concerns management of the account file (automatic loading and saving, encryption and backup copies).

Figure 3.1: Initial configuration of accounts file.

It is advisable to check the options:

- Automatically load last file on startup
- Automatically save on exit;
- Make a backup copy before saving files (checked by default).

WARNING: the Grisbi developers recommend that you do not use the *Encrypt Grisbi file* option for the following reasons:

- there is no method for recovering an encrypted file whose password has been lost;

- For some unknown reason, using this option on Windows can render the accounts file completely unusable.

However, if you use it, it is advisable to make regular back-ups of the unencrypted file.

2. The second wizard, "Welcome to Grisbi!" (or later "New file Assistant"), which automatically follows the first, includes six steps to help you create the account file.
3. This is followed automatically by the third wizard, "Create a new account", which is used to create the first account and is described in detail in section 3.3 below.

At any time you can exit any wizard with the *Cancel* button.

If you do not want to use the Set-up Wizard, you can open a example file instead (see the next section 3.2 below).

3.2 Example file

If you want to use Grisbi immediately without having to go through the full set-up, for example to get an idea of the possibilities of this program, you can download the **Example_3.0-en.gsb** file from *Sourceforge.net*[1] website in the folder "textsfexamples".

Note: in this example file, the names of the payees etc are pure invention; any similarity with a real person or business is entirely accidental.

3.3 Creation of a new accounts file

The first time you use Grisbi, you will need to create a first accounts file. The extension of this file will be **.gsb** and its name will be **your-file-name.gsb**.

Immediately afterwards, you will need to create at least one account (bank, cash, liability or asset account, described in the chapter 7 on page 47 *Account management*), and then a few other accounts (current, savings, credit, possibly a cash account and a few transition accounts) which will contain their respective transactions.

If you are managing a family, you will normally only have one accounts file, as this allows all the exchanges between your different accounts. If you are managing an association, or another family with no accounting relationship with the first, you will create another accounts file, which will have a different name **your-second-file-name.gsb**. This will keep the accounting entities separate.

In other words, all your household accounts are recorded in one file created by Grisbi, and all your association accounts are recorded in another file created by Grisbi.

Note: for those who are curious, the Grisbi file is in XML format, and the structure and organisation of the data is available on the website at *Sourceforge.net*[2].

The general procedure for creating an account file is as follows: click on the menu *File - New Account File* or on the New (fig. **??** on page ??) button; the account file creation wizard opens, which includes six steps, as detailed below:

1. Welcome window (step 1/6): confirm by clicking on the *Following* button:

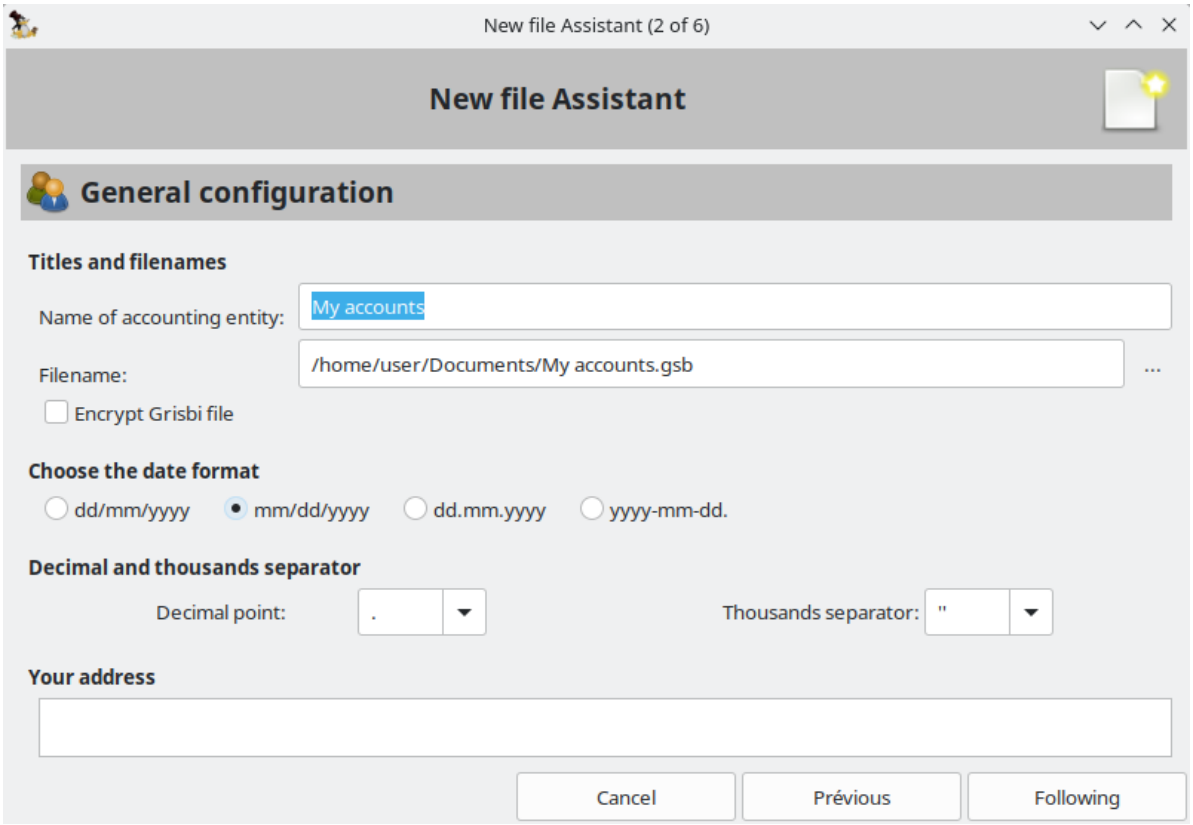

Figure 3.2: General configuration of a accounts file

2. General configuration (step 2/6) (fig. 3.2):
   a) choose the name of the accounting entity whose accounts you manage, for example "My accounts", which can be chosen as the title of the Grisbi application home page,
   b) enter the name of the accounts file with its complete tree structure; by default, Grisbi suggests the same name as that of the accounting entity, but you can change it,
   c) check the *Encrypt Grisbi* box if you wish to encrypt the accounts file,

   Warning: the Grisbi developers recommend that you do not use the *Encrypt Grisbi file* option for the following reasons:
   - there is no method for recovering an encrypted file whose password has been lost;
   - For some unknown reason, using this option on Windows can render the accounts file completely unusable.

   However, if you use it, it is advisable to make regular back-ups of the unencrypted file.

   d) select the date format with one of the four buttons
      - "dd/mm/yyyy" for "day/month/year",
      - "mm/dd/yyyy" for "month/day/year",
      - "dd.mm.yyyy" for "day.month.year",
      - "yyyy-mm-dd" for "year-month-day",
   e) choose the decimal separator and the thousands from the drop-down lists,
   f) fill in the address (optional),

[1] https://sourceforge.net/projects/grisbi/files/Documentation/
[2] https://sourceforge.net/projects/grisbi/files/Documentation/Format-fichier-grisbi/

g) confirm with the *Following* button;

3. selection of the base currency (step 3/6):
   a) click on the chosen currency in the list,
   b) check the "Include obsolete currencies" box if you also want to display old currencies,
   c) confirm with the *Following* button;
4. selection of the list of categories you will use (step 4/6) (fig. 3.3)

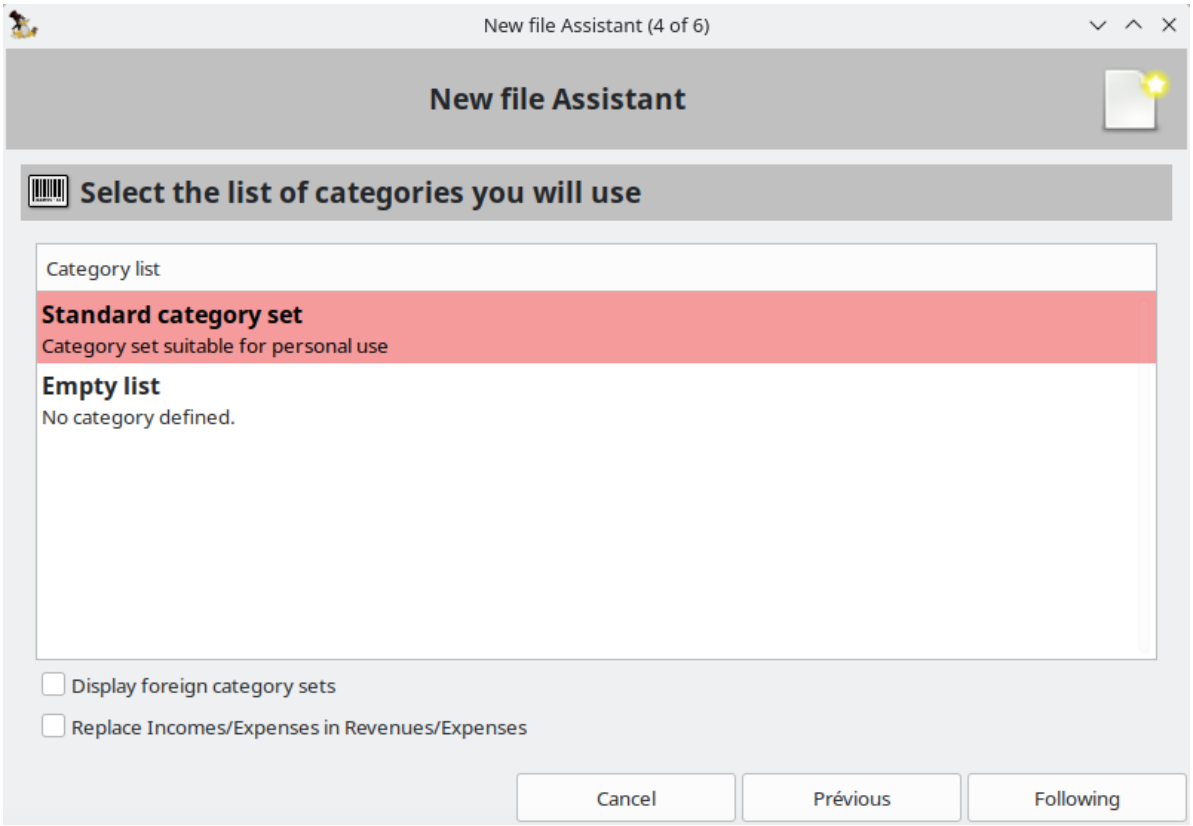

Figure 3.3: Selection of categories to be used

   a) click on your desired category, either the *Standard category list* or the *Empty list*[1]
   b) check the *Display foreign category sets* box to check if other categories are available[2]
   c) confirm with the *Following* button;
5. Enter details of banks holding your accounts (step 5/6):
   a) click *Add* to define a bank; fill in the details of the bank (name, bank code, etc.),
   b) select a bank from the list and click the *Remove* button to delete a bank, then confirm in the window that opens,
   c) confirm with the *Following* button to go to the next step, *Create a new account*:
6. Configuration finished (step 6/6):
   The configuration of the accounts file is now complete, and the window below will ask you to choose one of the two methods for creating your first account (fig. 3.4 on the following page):

[1] **Translators Note:** Users installing the program on a system with a French Language interface will find different categories are offered including some for business users

[2] **Translators Note:** This option is mainly for the benefit of users of a computer system with the French Language interface who will then be shown the two English categories mentioned in the previous step

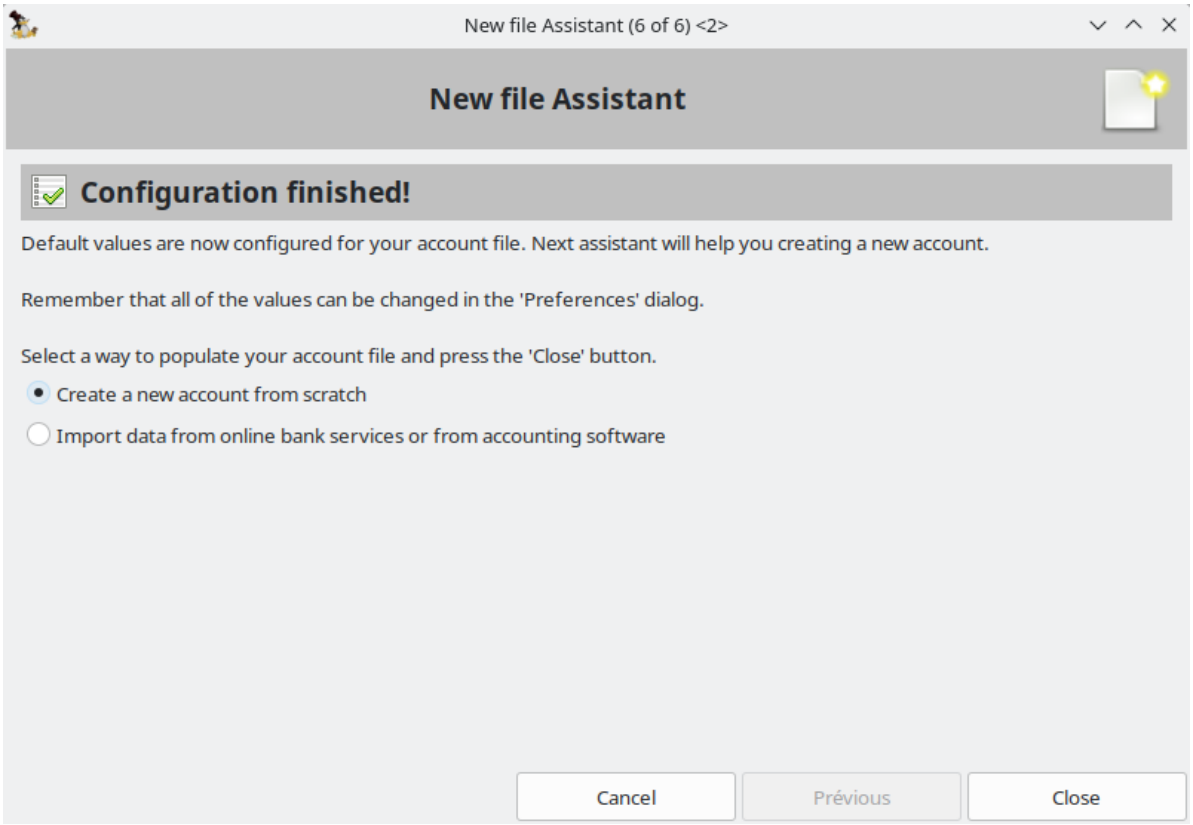

Figure 3.4: Choices when creating the first account

- *Create a new account from scratch*:
  If you check this line, then if you confirm with the *Close* button, this window closes and the "Create a new account" wizard starts. See 7.4 on page 50, *Creating a new account*, which fully describes this procedure, then return to this page;
- *Import data from online bank services or from accounting software*:
  If you check this line and then confirm with the *Close* button, this window closes and the "New file Assistant to import" Wizard for importing data from an accounts file, starts. See the **??** on page ?? section, *Importing Account Files from Another Programme into Grisbi*, which fully describes this procedure, then return to this page.

In one way or another, you have now created your Grisbi file, as well as the first account of this file.

If you want to create other accounts now, select the *Edit - New Account* to create another account (see the 7.4 on page 50, *Creating a new account* section).

Otherwise, you can start using the account you just created or the one from which you just imported the data.

WARNING: in general, it is inadvisable to have accents or spaces in the names of directories and files used by Grisbi. If so, rename them now. For example, spaces can be replaced by underscores ().

3.4 Saving your accounts file

Your operations are not written as you enter them as they might be in other software; you must therefore save your account file before exiting. Do not worry, Grisbi warns you if you have not done so.

You can configure the options for saving the account file in the *Edit - Preferences* menu, see the section **??** on page ??, *Managing Account Files.*.

3.5 Import from other personal accounting software

See the **??** on page ?? section to import account files from another program into Grisbi. For the moment, Grisbi supports Gnucash, OFX, CSV and QIF formats.

4 Entering Grisbi

4.1 Selecting a file

When you launch the application, Grisbi displays a page allowing you to get started in different ways.

You can display the Grisbi window in full screen by pressing the function key <F11>, and go back using the same key.

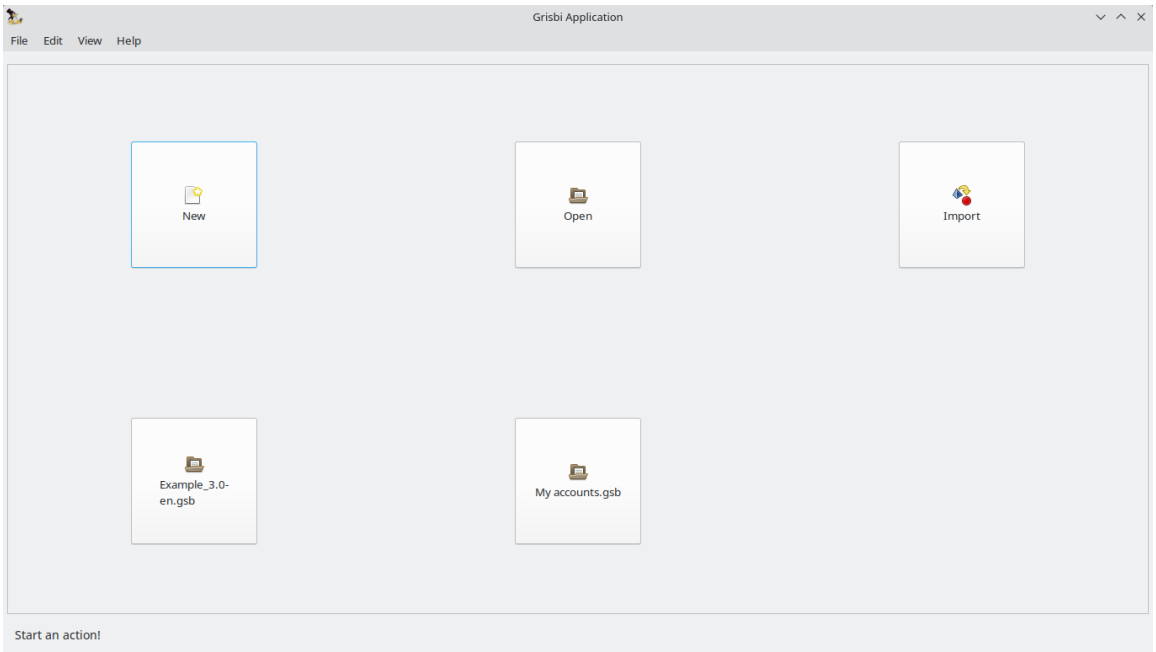

Figure 4.1: Start-up window

In addition to the menu bar, this window displays a number of panels:

- the “New” button to launch the wizard “New file Assistant”;
- the “Open” button, to display a file manager that you can use to search for an existing accounts file on your computer;
- the “Import” button, to launch the “New file Assistant to import” wizard;
- one or more other buttons, named after account files Grisbi has already used.

Note: buttons with the names of account files that Grisbi has already used are only present if these files exist; if you want to remove them from this entry page, move them to another directory, or delete them.

At the bottom of the page, a banner invites you to choose an action by selecting one of these buttons.

If you just want to discover the Grisbi software to get an idea of what it looks like and what it can do, you can instead use an example file like the one on the *Sourceforge.net*[1] site in the "examples" folder.

Note: by simply clicking on the downloaded example file, Grisbi will run, displaying the home window (fig. 4.2) directly without going through the start-up window.

4.2 Homepage

When an account file is opened, Grisbi displays its home page (fig. 4.2).This is the start page of the programme and can be accessed at any time by clicking on the *Accounts* tab.

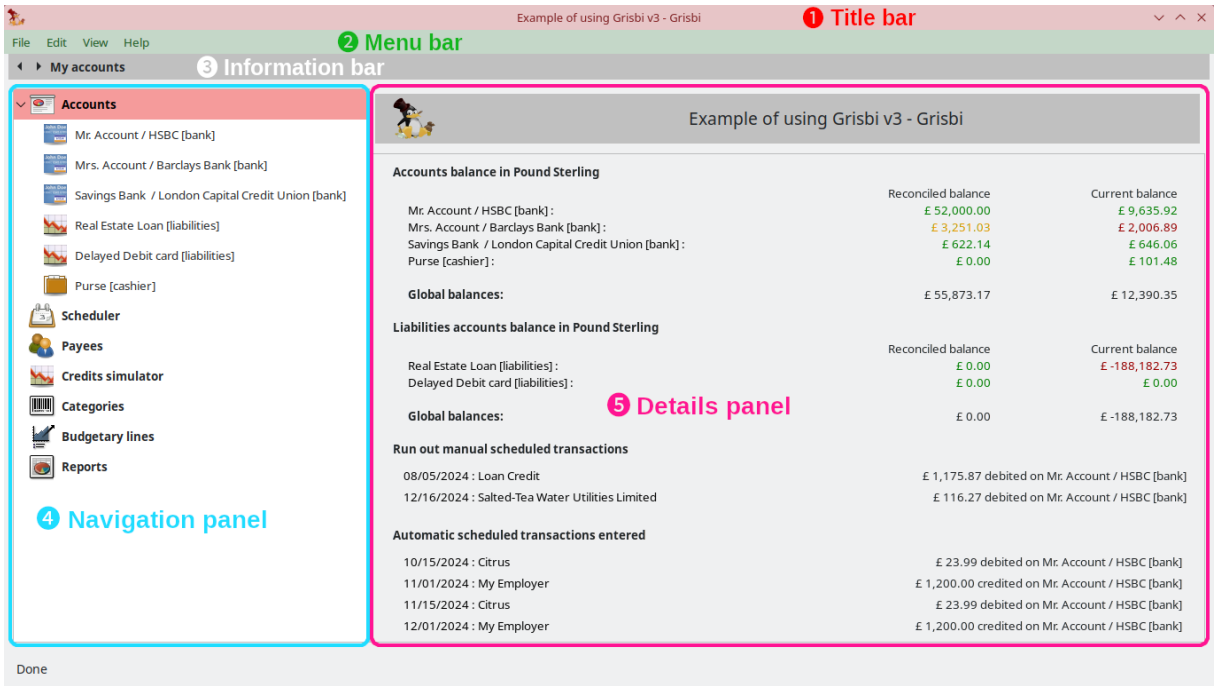

Figure 4.2: Accounts summary page

Grisbi displays all pages in the same way: like any software, it displays:

① the title bar

② the menu bar, which gives access to most of Grisbi's important functions;

as well as three specific Grisbi zones:

③ the information bar, under the menu bar;

④ the navigation panel;

⑤ the details panel;le panneau des détails

[1] https://sourceforge.net/projects/grisbi/files/Documentation/

4.3 Information bar

The information bar shows the name of the currently selected tab selected, and can display, completely to the right, certain balances relating to what is selected in the details panel.

Note: the information bar, displayed by default, can be hidden by unchecking a box in the preferences **??** on page ??.

To select one of the tabs displayed in the navigation panel click one or more times on one of the two small triangles on the top left of the panel. The items displayed are: *Accounts*, *Scheduler*, *Payees*, *Credits simulator*, *Categories*, *Budgetary lines* and *Reports*. If the *Accounts* and *Reports* items have been expanded to display their sub categories these will also be displayed one by one.

Note: Depending on the theme of the desktop environment or window manager you are using, these triangular symbols might be replaced by other characters such as +, -, >, <, etc.

The content of the selection is displayed in the details panel.

These functions can be used in place of the Navigation panel when its width is reduced to zero and you do not have direct access to it.

4.4 Navigation panel

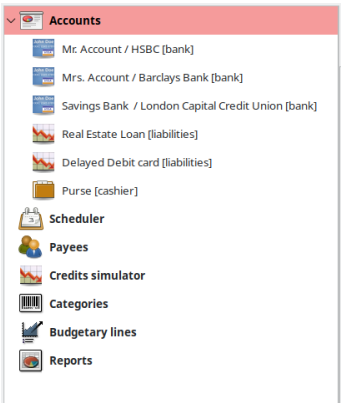

Fig. 4.3
Navigation panel

The navigation panel displays in bold the list of tabs:

- *Accounts*,
- *Scheduler*,
- *Payees*,
- *Credits simulator*,
- *Categories*,
- *Budgetary lines*,
- *Reports*.

By clicking on the small black triangle to the left of the *Accounts* or *Reports* tabs, you can scroll or roll up the list of their sub-tabs. You can change the order of tabs and sub-tabs by clicking on one of them and dragging it up or down the list.

Note: Depending on the theme of the desktop environment or window manager you are using, these triangular symbols might be replaced by other characters such as +, -, >, <, etc.

You can select one of these tabs or sub-tabs by clicking on its name. You can also move the selection in this list of tabs and sub-tabs with the Up Arrow, Down Arrow, Page Up ou Page Down keys, or with the mouse wheel (option to be checked in the preferences **??** on page ??).

The contents of the selection are displayed in the details panel.

You can reduce or enlarge the width of the navigation panel by clicking on the thin vertical bar between this panel and the details panel, and moving it. If the width of the window has been

reduced to zero, or enlarged to the maximum of the width of the Grisbi window, the thin vertical bar may be to the left or to the right of the window. Locate this and slide it back to the desired location.

The context menus, accessible by a right-click of the mouse, are available on the elements of this panel and offer the following functions:

- On *Accounts*:
  - *New account*;
- On any account:
  - *New account*,
  - *Remove this account*;
- On *Payees*:
  - *New payee*,
  - *Delete selected payee*,
  - *Edit selected payee*,
  - *Manage payees*,
  - *Remove unused payees*;
- On *Categories*:
  - *New category*,
  - *Delete selected category*,
  - *Edit selected category*,
  - *Import a file of categories* (*.csgb*),
  - *Export the list of categories* (*.csgb*):
- On *Budgetary lines*:
  - *New budgetary line*,
  - *Delete selected budgetary line*,
  - *Edit selected budgetary line*,
  - *Import a file of budgetary lines* (*.isgb*),
  - *Export the list of budgetary lines* (*.isgb*);
- On *Report*: *New report*;
- On any report:
  - *New report*,
  - *Remove this report*.

4.5 Details panel

The details panel displays all the details on the tabs or sub-tab selected by the Information bar or Navigation panel. This is the main work area of Grisbi.

You can reduce or enlarge its width by clicking on the thin vertical bar between this window and the navigation panel, and dragging it. If the width of the this panel has been reduced to zero or enlarged to the maximum of the width of the Grisbi window, the thin vertical bar may be to the left or to the right of the window. Locate this and slide it back to the desired location.

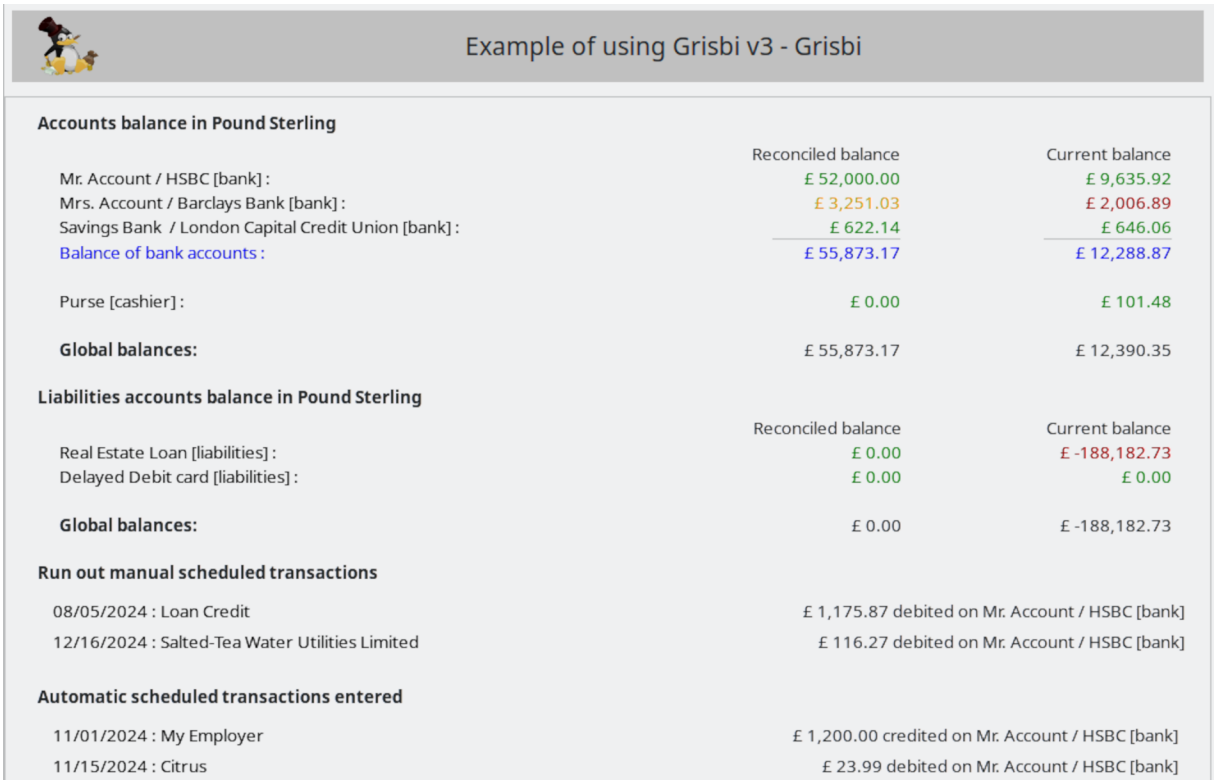

Figure 4.4: Modified details panel

4.5.1 Displaying details on the home page

By selecting the *Accounts* tab, the details panel displays:

- to the top in a grey background banner:
  - on the left, the *Grisbi* icon (which can be hidden, see **??** on page ??),
  - and on the right the title of the accounts file you currently have loaded, in the form "assigned name - Grisbi"; you can define this label, from among three possibilities, in the *Edit - Preferences* menu (see the **??** on page ?? paragraph, Addresses & titles):
    - the *Accounting entity* (by default): this is the name you use to identify the type of account e.g. "My Accounts" or "Business", which you entered when the account file was created; you can edit it here in the *Name of accounting entity* field; this can be useful if you manage multiple accounting entities,
    - the *Account owner name*: the name of the owner (or account manager) of the last account accessed; if the holder is not defined in the account properties, Grisbi displays the name of this account,
    - the *Filename*: this is the name of the file in the current directory, in the form **name_of_your_file.gsb**;
- in the main light grey area below the banner:
  - for each currency separately, for all accounts and groups of accounts, under the label *Reconciled balance* and *Current balance*:
    - the balance of the bank and cash accounts, the partial balance of the groups of accounts and their global balance,
      Note: you can adjust the display order of the partial balances of the account groups (see the section **??** on page ??, *Partial balances of the list of accounts*),

    - the balance of the liability accounts and their final balance,
    - the balance of the asset accounts and their final balance;
  - the warnings from automatically scheduled entries with their date, wording and amount, according to the choices made in the *Edit - Preferences* menu (see the section **??** on page ??, *Scheduler*),
  - the list of accounts whose balance has fallen below the *Minimum authorized balance*,
  - the list of accounts whose balance has fallen below the *Minimum desired balance*.

Note: For definitions of *Minimum authorized balance* and *Minimum desired balance*, see the 7.3 on page 48, *Account Properties* section.

The account labels are displayed in black: as the mouse cursor moves over the line of one of these, its colour changes to grey.

A balance greater than the *Minimum desired Balance* is displayed in green: as the cursor moves over the line, its colour changes to light green.

A balance less than the *Minimum desired balance* and greater than the *Minimum authorized balance* is displayed in orange: as the pointer passes on its line, this color changes to light orange.

A balance less than the *Minimum authorized Balance* is displayed in dark red: as the pointer passes over its line, this color changes to red.

When you move the mouse pointer over the line of an account, any color change indicates that if you click (right or left) with the mouse, the records contained in the highlighted account is displayed, as if the account had been selected with the information bar or navigation panel.

A partial balance can be specified for a group of accounts If defined this is displayed in dark blue (as in the figure 4.4 on the preceding page). If it is negative, it may appear in dark red, (see **??** on page ??, *Balances partials of the list of accounts*). A partial balance line does not change color when the mouse pointer is over it, because you can not view the individual entries for of an group of accounts.

You can configure certain aspects of the display of the details panel:

- in the *Edit - Preferences* menu:
  - *Generalities*:
    - *Various settings*, *Scheduler* tab: section **??** on page ??;
    - *Main page*:
      * *Calculation of balance*: paragraph **??** on page ??,
      * *Balances partials of the list of accounts*: paragraph **??** on page ??;
  - *Display*:
    - *Fonts & Logo*: section **??** on page ??,
    - *Addresses & titles*: section **??** on page ??;
- in the *Properties* tab of each account in the *Balances* section:
  - Accounts below the *Minimum authorised balance*: section 7.3 on page 48:
  - Accounts below the *Minimum desired Balance*: section 7.3 on page 48.

4.6 Menu bar

As in many graphics applications, most of Grisbi's important features are accessible through the menus in the Menu Bar. The features are detailed below.

4.6.1 *File* menu

This menu includes the following functions:

- *New window*: non-functional (perhaps in the future?)
- *New account file*: creates a new Grisbi file of extension **.gsb**; the current file is therefore closed and a new empty file is created with an empty account (shortcut Ctrl + N), see the section 3.3 on page 19; not to be confused with the creation of a new account;
- *Open*: opens your file manager, allowing you to search for, select and open an account file with the **.gsb** extension (shortcut Ctrl + O).
- *Recently opened files*: displays a list of the last n files opened with Grisbi (only if more than one has been opened); this number is configurable in the menu *Edit - Preferences*, see section **??** on page ??, *Account Files Management*;

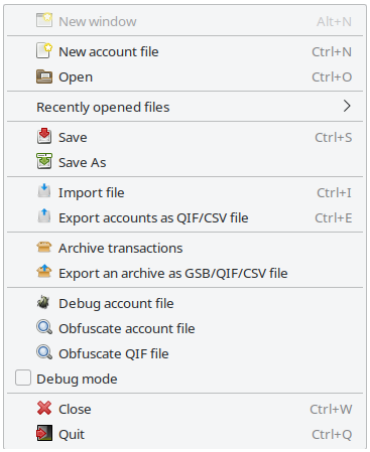

Fig. 4.5
File menu

- *Save*: Saves the current account file (shortcut Ctrl + S);
- *Save As*: opens a file manager to save the current accounts file with the name and location of your choice; Grisbi defaults to the current directory, the name of the current accounts file, with the **.gsb** extension;
- *Import file*: starts the "Importing transactions into Grisbi" wizard of another software (shortcut Ctrl + I); see **??** on page ??;
- *Export accounts as QIF/CSV file*: starts the "Exporting Grisbi accounts" wizard (shortcut Ctrl + E); see **??** on page ??;
- *Archive transactions*: starts the archive creation wizard; see **??** on page ??;
- *Export an archive as .gsb/QIF/CSV file*: starts the archive export wizard; see **??** on page ??;
- *Debug account file*: starts the debug wizard for this file, which will help you look for inconsistencies in your account file; see **??** on page ??;
- *Obfuscate account file*: starts the wizard that produces an anonymous copy of your account file; this file can be attached to a bug report; see **??** on page ??;
- *Obfuscate QIF file*: starts the wizard that produces an anonymous copy of this file; this file can be attached to a bug report; see **??** on page ??;
- *Debug mode*: puts Grisbi in debug mode, which creates a log file of events; see **??** on page ??;
- *Close*: closes the current accounts file; Grisbi offers to save it if you have not already done it (shortcut Ctrl + W);
- *Quit*: close Grisbi; Grisbi will first ask you to save the accounts file, if you have not already done so (shortcut Ctrl + Q);

4.6.2 *Edit* menu

Note: in the *Edit* menu, some entries are only active when an account or transaction is selected.
This menu includes the following functions:

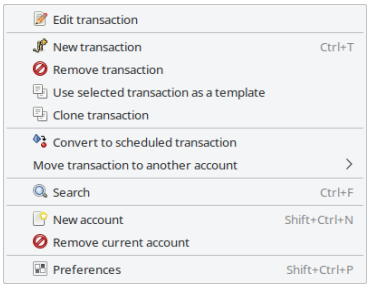

Fig. 4.6
Edit menu

- *Edit transaction*: allows a selected transaction to be rectified, see section 8.10 on page 77, *Modification d'une opération*;
- *New transaction*: allows the creation of a new transaction in an account (shortcut Ctrl + T), see the section 8.6 on page 68, *Saisie d'une nouvelle opération*;
- *Remove transaction*: deletes a selected transaction, see section 8.11 on page 78, *Deleting a transaction*;
- *Use selected transaction as a template*: creates a copy of a selected transaction, with the current date entered in the transaction form, see section 8.12 on page 78, *Selecting a transaction for use as a template*;
- *Clone transaction*: creates a copy identical to the selected transaction and opens the transaction form, see section 8.13 on page 78, *Clone a transaction*;
- *Convert to scheduled transaction*: see section 8.14 on page 79, *Converting a transaction to a scheduled transaction*;
- *Move transaction to another account*: moves the transaction to the selected account, see section 8.15 on page 79, *Moving a transaction to another account*;
- *Search* (shortcut Ctrl + F):
  - displays the search box when you select:
    - an account or a transaction,
    - the "Payees" tab or a payee,
    - the "Categories" tab or a category,
    - the "Budgetary lines" tab or a budgetary line is selected

    (see chapter **??** on page ??, *alphanumeric search*)-> TO CREATE
  - opens the properties window for a report when the "Reports" tab of the navigation panel or a report is selected, see chapter **??** on page ??, *Création d'un état*;
- *New account*: starts the wizard for creating a new account in your Grisbi file (shortcut Shift + Ctrl + N), see section 7.4 on page 50, *Creating a new account*;
- *Remove current account*: deletes the selected account from your Grisbi file, see section 7.7 on page 53, *Removing the current account*;
- *Preferences*: allows you to configure Grisbi (shortcut Shift ⇧ + Ctrl + P); see the chapter **??** on page ??, *Configuration of Grisbi*.

4.6.3 *View* menu

Note: in the *View* menu, entries are only active when an account is selected.
This menu includes the following functions:

- *Show transaction form*: expands the Transaction/Scheduled form for the selected account;
- *Show reconciled*: displays reconciled transactions for the selected account (shortcut Alt + R);
- *Show lines archives*: displays the archive lines for the selected account (shortcut Alt + L);
- *Show closed accounts*: displays account(s) that have been closed and not deleted, see section 7.3 on page 48, *Account properties*?;

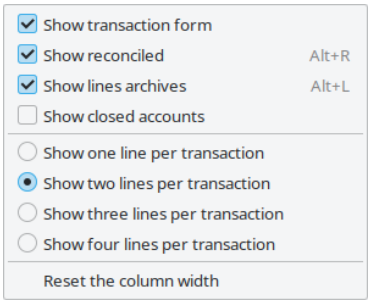

Fig. 4.7
View Menu

The following four functions can be used to configure the display of transactions for the selected account:

- *Show one line per transaction*
- *Show two lines per transaction*
- *Show three lines per transaction*
- *Show four lines per transaction*

And finally, the last function in the view menu:

- *Reset the column width*: allows you to reset the columns of the tranaction lists to their original width.

4.6.4 *Help* menu

Most of the choices in this menu give links to websites. In order for these links to work, you must have specified to Grisbi the navigation software (or Web browser) that you wish to use, in the *Edit - Preferences* menu (see **??** on page ??, *Programmes*). The *Help* menu includes the following choices:

- *User's Manual*: opens the "Grisbi Manual" in your browser or in your PDF reader according to your choice (see **??** on page ??, *Help display*)(shortcut F1);
- *Quick start*: opens your browser to the "Grisbi Quick Start page";
- *About*: displays the program information box: you will find details about the version, the link to Grisbi's site, the acknowledgements page (contributors to the project) and the user license;
- *Grisbi website*: opens your browser to the *Grisbi*[1] web site

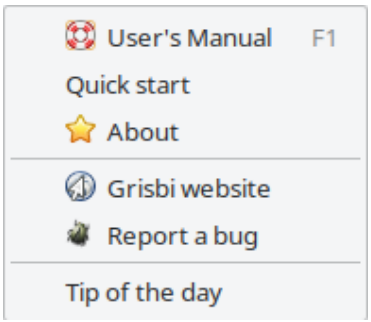

Fig. 4.8
Help menu

- *Report a bug*: opens your browser to the *Grisbi Bug Tracker page*[2] to allow you to report a bug that you have discovered. You can also follow on this page the evolution of the corrections made to the reported bugs;
- *Tip of the day*: opens a dialog box that displays a tip of use, different each time Grisbi starts; you can successively display all the tips, and choose whether or not the display of

[1] https://en.grisbi.org
[2] https://www.grisbi.org/bugsreports/

the tip of the day when starting Grisbi. To remove or reactivate the tip of the day, see **??** on page ??, *Tip of the day*.

4.7 Shortcut keys

Keyboard shortcuts make it easy to enter data and navigate through Grisbi's windows, avoiding the need to move and click. By using the ones corresponding to the most common manipulations for you, you improve your ergonomics by limiting the important movements of your arms.

Grisbi has a number of keyboard shortcuts, listed in the Grisbi preferences (see **??** on page ??), presented here according to different themes (see also 2.8.2 on page 16, *Typographical conventions in this manual*).

4.7.1 Application and files

- Create a new Grisbi file: Ctrl + N
- Open a Grisbi file: Ctrl + O
- Add a new account to the Grisbi file: Ctrl + Shift ⇧ + N
- Save the Grisbi file: Ctrl + S
- Import a file: Ctrl + I
- Export to QIF/CSV file: Ctrl + E
- Close the Grisbi file: Ctrl + W
- Close Grisbi: Ctrl + Q

4.7.2 Navigation panel

- Select a tab or an account: ↑, ↓
- On the Accounts tab:
  - Opens the accounts list: →
  - Closes the accounts list: ←
- On an account or the Scheduler tab:
  - Switches to the list of transactions or planned transactions: →
  - Switches to the navigation panel: ←
- On a selected account:
  - Displays the character search window: Ctrl + F
- On the Reports tab:
  - Opens the search report properties window: Ctrl + F
- Select the first/last tab (Accounts/Reports): PageUp or PageDown

4.7.3 List of transactions or scheduled transactions

- Move selection: ↑ or ↓
- Select a transaction: Enter ↵

- New transaction:
  - On an empty line: Enter ↵
  - On an existing transaction: Ctrl + T
- Modify a transaction: Enter ↵
- Delete a transaction: Delete
- Point ou unpoint a transaction for a reconciliation:
  - in the reconciliation mode: Ctrl + P, F12 ou Space,
  - out of reconciliation mode: Ctrl + P or F12
- Reconcile or un-reconcile a transaction: Ctrl + R
  Note: out of reconciliation mode, grisbi opens a windows asking you to select a reconciliation.
- Show or hide reconciled transactions: Alt + R
- Roll out/in a splitted transaction: Space
- Show or hide archival lines: Alt + L
- In the list of account transactions:
  - Open the character search window: Ctrl + F

4.7.4 Transaction/Scheduled form

- The Enter ↵ key is configurable (see preferences **??** on page ??): it can be set to either move in the input form, or to validate the entry;
- Move to the next field: Tab ⇤⇥ (depending on your configuration choice);
- Cancel the current entry: Esc
- Accept auto-complete: Tab ⇤⇥ ou Enter ↵ (depending on your configuration choice);
- Euro symbol: Alt Gr + E

4.7.5 Drop down lists

- Open a list: PageUp, PageDown or ↓
- Move to the top of the list: PageUp
- Move to the bottom of the list: PageDown
- Move in the list: ↑ or ↓
- Validate a choice within a list: Enter ↵ or Tab ⇤⇥ en fonction de votre configuration (see **??** on page ??);
- Currencies, financial years and methods of payment:
  - Open list: Space
  - Move in the list: ↑ or ↓
  - Validate the item in the list: Space

4.7.6 Dates entered on the calendar

- Open a monthly calendar (on the date field): Ctrl + Enter ↵
- Closes the calendar without changing the date: Esc
- Validate the selected date: Enter ↵
- Next or previous day: + or -, → or ←
- Previous or next week: ↑ or ↓
- Previous or next month: PageUp or PageDown
- First day or last day of the month: Home / ↖ or End

4.7.7 Dates entered by keyboard

- Next or previous day: + or -
- Previous or next week: Ctrl + + or Ctrl + -
- Previous or next month: PageDown or PageUp
- Previous or Next Year: Ctrl + PageDown or Ctrl + PageUp
- Validate the selected date: Enter ↵

4.7.8 Payees, categories, budgetary lines, credits simulator, historical data and forecast

- Move selection: ↑, ↓, PageUp or PageDown
- Display sub-categories or sub-budgetary lines (on a sub-category or a sub-budgetary line): +
- Display the transactions of sub-categories or sub-budgetary lines (on a sub-category or a sub-budgetary line): Enter ↵

4.7.9 Configuration

- Show the Grisbi preferences window: Ctrl + Shift ⇧ + P

4.7.10 Help

- Open the Grisbi Manual: F1

5 Importing and exporting accounts

You can not directly use data that has been created by other personal accounting applications in Grisbi, and vice versa. Because these applications work differently, their data is structured differently, so you need to convert their data structure before you can use it.

This conversion can not be done at once on all data, but must be done separately for each account managed by the application. To convert each of these accounts, you must first "export" them from the original application and then "import" them into the destination application.

Note: do not confuse the Grisbi file, with the extension **.gsb**, which contains all the data of all the accounts created for the management of an accounting entity, and the "account files", which are files that contain only data from one account at a time, and created only to export or import that data from one accounting application to another. These "account files" must have a file format (or extension) that must be compatible with the original application AND the destination application.

Grisbi currently supports Gnucash, OFX, CSV and QIF personal accounting data formats.

5.1 Importing accounts from another accounting application

If you want to use account data that has been created in another accounting application in Grisbi, you must first export each of the accounts of this application individually to a set of files, then import these same files into Grisbi.

5.1.1 Export an account file from the other accounting application

The first step is, in the originating personal accounting application, to export each account in a file in the chosen format. The chosen format must be compatible with the export formats supported by the original application *and* compatible with import to Grisbi.

The export procedure is obviously different for each accounting application, so refer to its documentation. If you want to export all accounts, you will need to get as many files as you have accounts managed by the application.

5.1.2 Importing account files from another accounting application to Grisbi

Note: Grisbi allows you to import one or more account files in one operation. Although you can import the account files one by one, it is important to import all the account files at the same time, so that Grisbi can recreate the links between the accounts, especially with regard to the transfer operations.

For more information on the account types that Grisbi can manage, see the 7.8 on page 53, *Grisbi account types* section.

The import can be configured in the *Edit - Preferences* menu (Ctrl + Shift + P), *Generalities - Import* menu, *Files import* tab (see section **??** on page ??).

You can define which date will be used for assigning a financial year to each imported operation, see **??** on page ??, *Definition of Financial Year*.

Grisbi also allows you to establish an association between a string of characters in this file and a payee. For example, all labels containing "rent" may be associated with a payee that represents your landlord. This must be configured in the *Edit - Preferences* menu (Ctrl + shift + P), *Généralities - Import* menu, *Associations for import* tab (see the **??** on page ?? section).

In the Grisbi *File* menu, choose the option *Import file* (or use the shortcut Ctrl + I), which opens the import wizard window. The import of the account files takes place in five steps, to which one step must be added for each additional account:

1. Launches the import assistant (step 1/4): confirm with the *Following* button;
2. Selection of the account files to import (step 2/4) (fig. 5.1):
   a) click the button *Add file to import...* button : a file manager window opens;

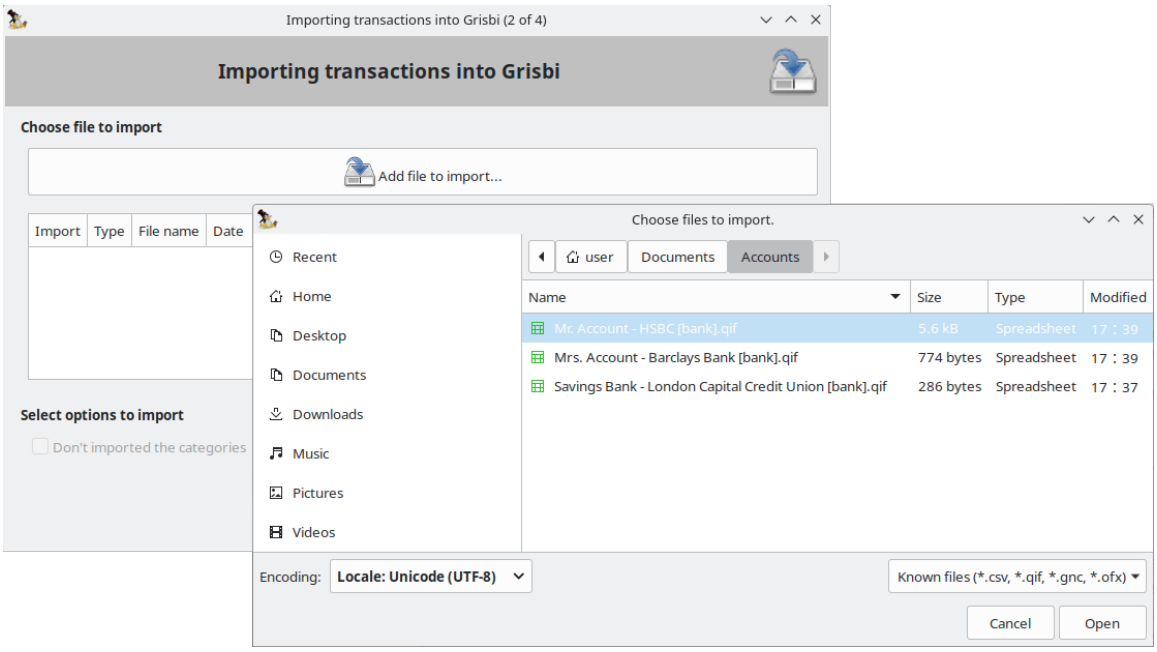

Figure 5.1: Selecting accounts to import

   b) look for the directory where these account files are,
   c) select one or more account files (with the combination Ctrl + Left-Click and Shift + Left-Click); you can also change the locale (character encoding) of the files to import from the *Encoding* drop-down menu,
   d) validate the window with the *Open* button to return to the account file selection window;
   e) you can choose not to import categories by ticking the appropriate option. When importing a CSV file, a new window allows you to choose the import settings (fig. 5.2 on the next page):

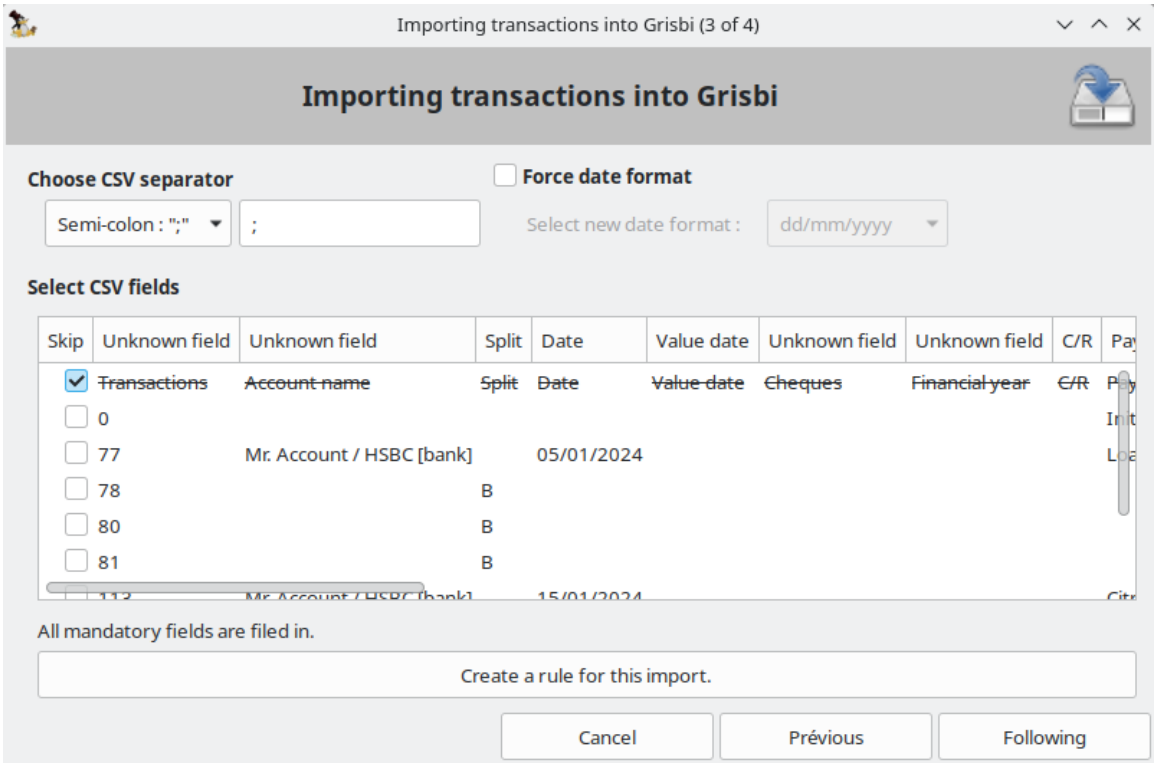

Figure 5.2: Configuring the import of a CSV file

- **Choose CSV separator**: the separator between data can be selected from the drop-down list in the left-hand window and is displayed in the right-hand window, where you can also modify it;
- **Force date format**: the date format can be forced by ticking the appropriate box and selecting it from the drop-down list;
- **Select CSV fields**: you can tick the data lines that *will not be* imported;
- the "Create a rule for this import." button (at the bottom) allows you to create an import rule that you will need to name in order to validate it. You will find it in the account toolbar (see 8.1 on page 61).

f) when the desired files are checked, you can validate the selection with the *Following* button;

3. Complete the import of the account files: if everything went well, this window gives the list of the account files which will be imported; continue the import by confirming with the *Following* button;

4. Creating and configuring each account imported into Grisbi (step 4): you can review each account and choose the following actions (fig. 5.3 on the next page):
   - *Create a new account*:this will add the selected file as a new account in your Grisbi file. The drop-down menu *Account type* below will allow you to change the account type;
   - *Add transactions to an account*:if scheduled operations are found within the specified time interval, a specific window opens to ask what you want to do with them: either merge these scheduled operations with the corresponding imported operations, or add the imported operations in addition to them (see the section **??** on page ??, *Import settings*). The *Account name* drop-down menu below will allow you to select the account to which the transactions will be added;

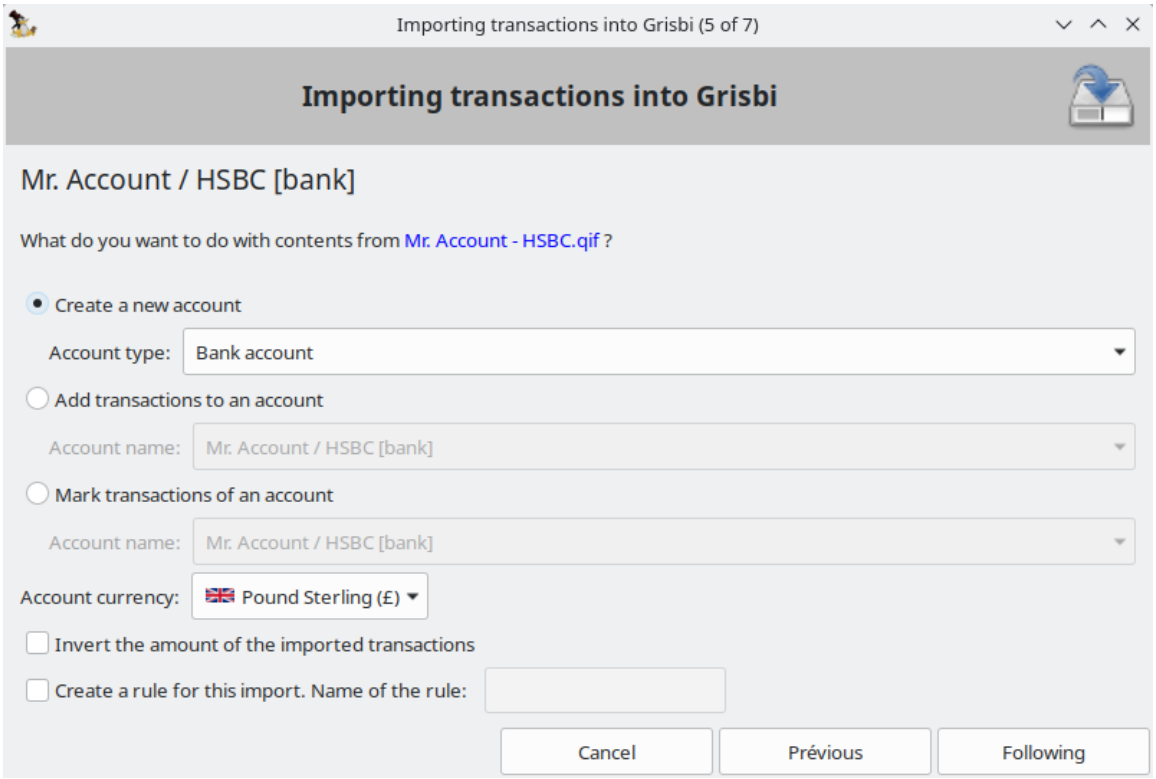

Figure 5.3: Configuration of each imported account

- *Mark transactions of an account*:this will mark the transactions with a "T" in the "C/R" column (8.2.2 on page 62) of the account concerned. If any orphan transactions are found, a window will open at the end of the import to ask what you want to do with them: either add them or ignore them. The *Account name* drop-down menu below will allow you to select the account in which the transactions will be marked;
- set the currency of the account (or create a new one);
- *Invert the amount of the imported transactions*: useful for credit card accounts for example;
- *Create a rule for this import*:allows you to define a quick import rule if the file is in QIF, Gnucash, or OFX format and only if you add or mark transactions to an account. This rule is specific to each account and must be named in order to be validated. You can find it in the account toolbar (see 8.1 on page 61);
- when everything is correct, confirm the import with the Following button;

5. Confirm the end of the import: confirm with the *Close* button.

If, and only if you have created your account file just before this account data import, return to the end of the 3.3 on page 22, Creation of a new accounts file. Go directly to the end of the account file creation process, at the paragraph beginning with *In one way or another...* , which will prompt you to create other accounts right away.

Otherwise, you can start using the account you just created.

5.2 Export accounts from Grisbi

If you want to use account data created by Grisbi in another accounting application, you must first export this data to files and then import them into the other application using these files. The file format chosen must be compatible with the export by Grisbi *and* compatible with the import by the destination application.

In the *File* menu select the *Export accounts as QIF/CSV file* (ou use shortcut Ctrl + E) that opens the Exporting Grisbi accounts wizard. Exporting accounts involves at least four steps:

1. Starting the assistant (step 1/3): this window indicates that, since the QIF and CSV file formats do not support currency, all transactions will be converted into the currency of their respective account; confirm with the *Following* button;
2. Selecting accounts and options (fig. 5.4):

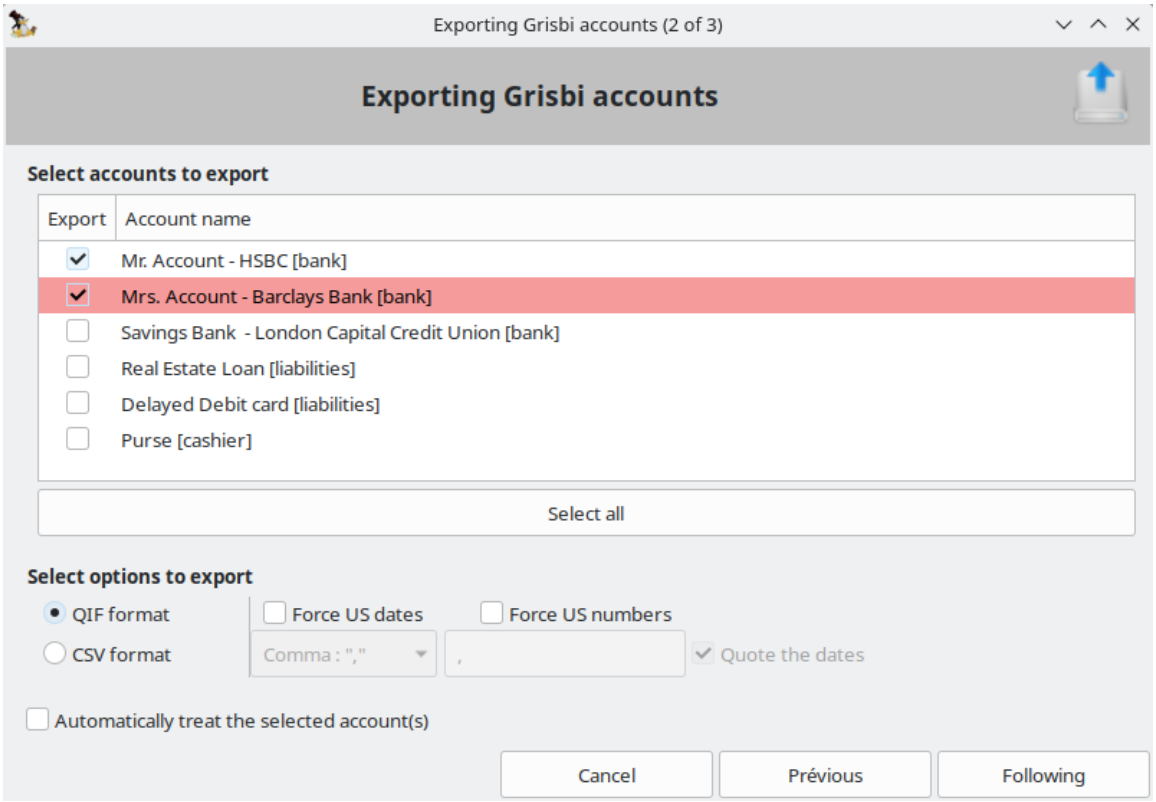

Figure 5.4: Exporting accounts

- **Select accounts to export** (step 2/3): select the accounts to export by clicking in the corresponding box or on the *Select all* button;
- **Select options to export**:
  - *QIF format*: exports the selected account(s) in QIF format; in addition, the option:
    - *Force US dates*: saves the date in the format "month/day/year" (mm/dd/yyyy),
    - *Force US numbers*: uses the period "." as the decimal separator and the comma "," as the thousands separator;
  - *CSV format*: exports the selected account(s) in CSV format; in addition to the options available in QIF format (above):

- the separator between data can be selected from the drop-down list in the left window and is displayed in the right window, where you can also modify it.
- *Quote the dates*: if checked (default), dates will be enclosed in quotation marks, like other data. Hovering over the menu with the mouse opens an information window "Uncheck to write a date field without quotes";

- *Automatically treat the selected account(s)*: this option automatically exports the selected account(s):
  - with a file name generated as follows:
    [name of accounting entity]-[account name].[selected extension],
  - and saves it to the folder where the Grisbi file was opened; If the exported file(s) already exist(e), Grisbi will ask you to confirm whether you want to overwrite them; hovering over the menu with the mouse opens a following information window:
    "The generated files will be named as follows:
    [accounting entity]-[account name].[extension]
    The save folder will be the Grisbi file folder"

  Note: it is recommended not to use the character "/" in the account name, otherwise an error may occur when exporting to Linux systems.
- confirm with the *Following* button;

3. For each account, define the name of the file, the destination directory and the export format; the option *Name files automatically* bypasses this step. Then confirm with the *Following* button;
4. the export completion window appears; confirm with the *Close* button;

WARNING: in general, it is inadvisable to have accents, spaces or special characters in the names of directories and files used by Grisbi. If so, rename them now. For example, spaces can be replaced by underscores (_).

6 Data management

The data you enter into Grisbi must be carefully preserved and protected against accidental loss. Grisbi provides three tools to address this issue:

- *Account files handling* created by Grisbi,
- the *Backups* of these same files,
- the *Archiving* of transactions stored in these files.

6.1 Account files handling

You can set the following management options in the menu *Edit - Preferences*:

- automatically load last file on startup;
- automatically saving on exit;
- Force saving of locked files;
- Encrypt Grisbi file;
- Compress Grisbi file (see compression);
- Memorise last opened files.

All of these options are explained in detail and can be configured in the *Edit - Preferences* menu (see **??** on page ??, *Account files handling*).

6.2 Backups

In general, no matter what data you have on your computer's hard drive, you need to make backups of it, for the simple reason that *any data storage system has a limited lifetime*. Making backups is designed to limit the risk of data loss.

Grisbi allows you to make automatic backups of your accounts file. These backups should be stored in a special directory or a special partition of your computer's disk, with backups of all your other data, which would then allow you to easily back up this directory or partition, preferably on different types of media, independent of the computer, and put in a safe place.

Note: take these tips seriously and do not take risks with your data, this can save you many setbacks. . .

Grisbi can automatically save, in a directory to be defined:

- either a single backup file that is replaced regularly with a name of the form **name_of_file_backup.gsb** and that is replaced regularly with,

- or backup files that accumulate in this directory; the name of these backup files is of the form **name_of_file_YYYYMMDDTHHMMSS.gsb**, where:
  - "name_of_file" is the name of your Grisbi file,
  - "YYYYMMDD" is the date in year-month-day format
  - "T" (for *time*) separates the date (left) and time (right) indications,
  - "HHMMSS" is the time in hours-minutes-seconds.

  This format is based on the international ISO 8601 date format, which means, among other things, that your backup directory can be automatically sorted alphanumerically and chronologically.

Grisbi provides you the following backup options:

- the creation of a single backup file, otherwise the backup files are added to their directory;
- the compression of the backup file, to occupy less disk space;
- backup after opening the Grisbi file;
- backup before saving the Grisbi file;
- setting the interval between two backups, in minutes;
- setting the deletion of backups according to their age, in months;
- setting the backup directory.

All of these options are described in detail and can be configured in the *Edit - Preferences* menu (see **??** on page ??, *Backups*).

6.3 Archiving

An archive is a little like "placing in parentheses" some of the entries from ***all*** the accounts in your file created by Grisbi. Entries inside an archive are no longer displayed and can no longer be processed, but are preserved. You can always unarchive an existing archive at any time to access its data.

When you use Grisbi, you enter transactions into your different accounts. These operations are all stored in the computer's memory and hard disk, and a few of these are displayed on the screen. The display and processing of account entries consumes memory and microprocessor time.

As time goes by, there are more and more operations recorded, so their display and processing require more and more memory space and microprocessor time. Your computer (depending on its specification) will eventually start to run Grisbi more slowly.

To limit this loss of performance in the display and the processing, in particular in report generation or in the search for information, Grisbi prompts you to choose a portion of your transactions and to put them in an archive, that is, to set them apart so that they are not affected by future postings or operations.

6.3.1 Creating an archive

The creation of an archive can be triggered automatically or manually:

6.3.1.1 Automatic triggering of archive creation

When a certain number of registered transactions is reached, Grisbi can warn you that this quantity of operations has not yet been archived. To do this, you will need to activate *Automatic check* of archives in the Grisbi preferences (see paragraph **??** on page ??).

Check the option *Check at opening if creating archive is needed*:

- will launch the archiving assistant when you open your Grisbi file if the trigger threshold is reached,
- activates the warning threshold of three thousand transactions (minimum by default), labelled *Warn if more than . . . transactions are not archived*.

The first window of the *Archive transactions* wizard will inform you of the total number of transactions recorded in your file.

Once archiving is complete, the counting process is reset to zero and Grisbi will display the same warning again after three thousand additional transactions.

6.3.1.2 Manual creation of an archive

Manual creation can be performed in addition to or instead of automatic launch. The warning about the number of unarchived transactions is not active.

1. in the menu bar, select *File - Archive transactions*: the archive creation wizard window appears; confirm by clicking the *Following* button;
2. in the next window, you can choose from three modes for selecting the transactions to be archived (fig. 6.1):

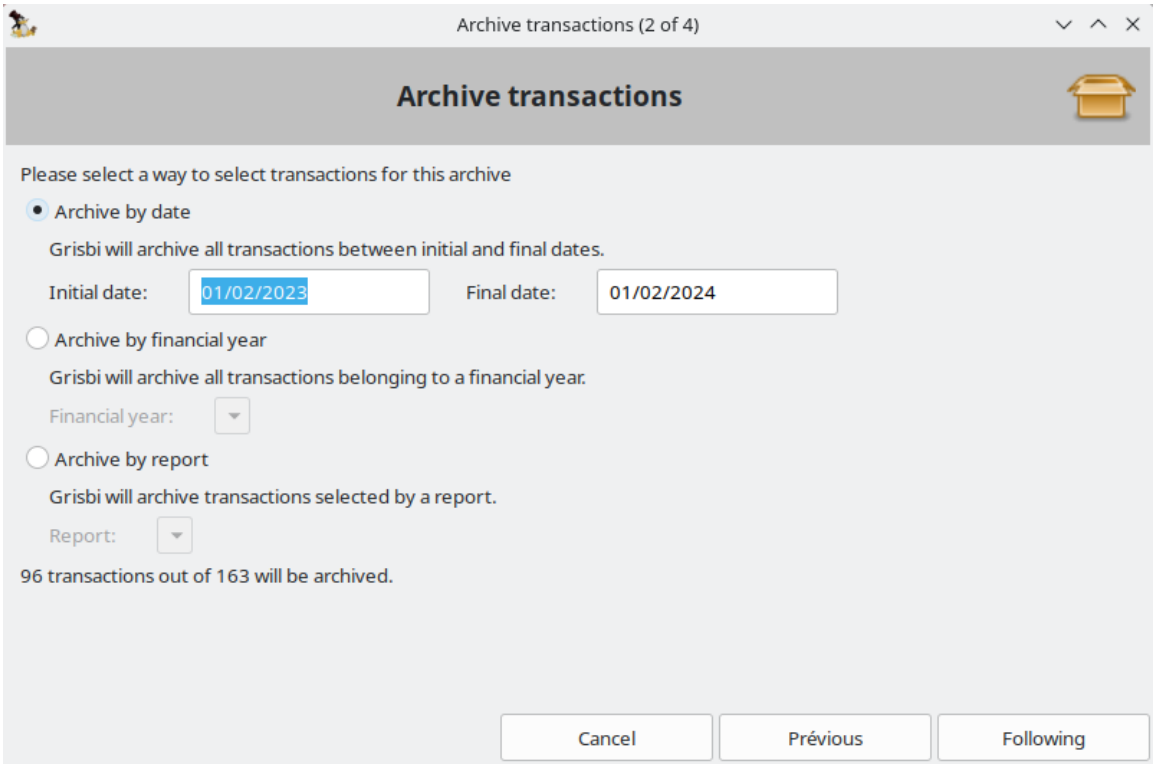

Figure 6.1: Creating an archive

- *Archive by date*: enter the *Initial date* and *Final date* in the appropriate fields,
- *Archive by financial year*: select a financial year available from the drop-down list,
- *Archive by report*: select a report available from the drop-down list;

  Note: the last line of the window indicates either an error in entering these parameters (in red) or the number of transactions that will be archived (all accounts combined) out of the total number of transactions in your Grisbi file.

3. confirm by clicking the *Following* button;
4. in the next window, enter the name you want to give to this archive; confirm with the *Apply* button;
5. the last window informs you that the archive has been created and displays the name of the archive as well as the number of archived transactions *all accounts combined* out of the total number of transactions in your Grisbi file; confirm with the *Close* button or click on the *Previous* button to create another archive.

Note: in case Grisbi has become slower after creating an archive, you can configure it to not load the close transactions (R) on startup, in order to increase its speed, (see the 8.1, *Tools bar*).

6.3.2 Displaying archives

The display of an archive appears at the top of the list of transactions for *each account*, in the form of a transaction line on a green background, indicating the start date of the archive (for an archive by date), its name and creation parameters (dates, financial year or report name), as well as the number of archived transactions *for the account displayed* (fig. **??** on page ??).

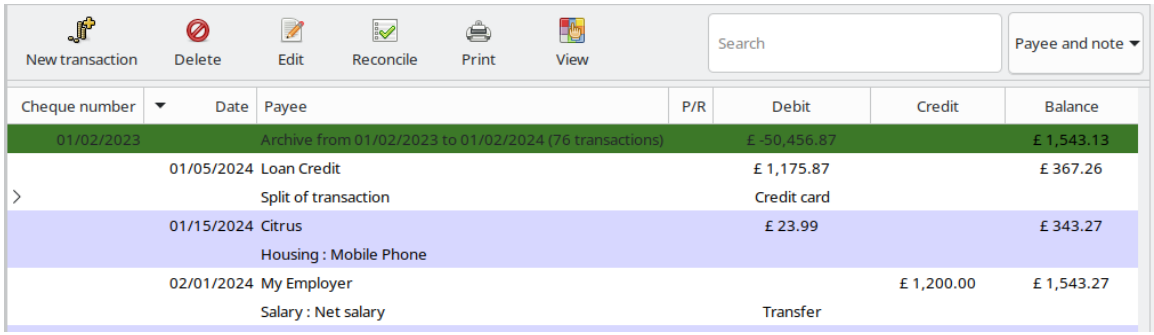

Figure 6.2: Archive line displayed

You can display (or hide) the archive line for all accounts by selecting (or deselecting) the box in the *View - Show lines archives* menu, or by clicking on *View* in the menu bar, then checking (or unchecking) *Show lines archives* (Alt + L) in the drop-down list.

If you want to view the transactions within an archive, you can open this archive by double-clicking on its line: after confirmation in the window that appears, the operations are displayed in the list.

Note: this is only opening the archive for display, the archive is not deleted. The next time you use Grisbi, the green line of the archive will reappear at the top of each account list. To permanently delete the archive, see the section 6.3.5 on the following page, *Deleting an archive*.

6.3.3 Parameters of an archive

You can consult the parameters that were defined during the creation of an archive, in the *Edit - Preferences - Generalities - Archives* menu. For this see the **??** on page ??, *Known Archives*.

6.3.4 Editing an archive

You can only change the name of an archive in the *Edit - Preferences* menu. For this see the **??** on page ??, *Archive modification* section.

6.3.5 Deleting an archive

You can delete an existing archive, in the *Edit - Preferences* menu. There are two separate delete functions: deleting an archive while *retaining* its transactions,and deleting an archive while *deleting* all its transactions. For this see **??** on page ??, *Archive modification* section.

6.3.6 Export an archive

Exporting an archive creates a file containing a copy of the archive, so that you can store it or use it in another Grisbi account file or in another accounting application. Exporting can only be done using the file formats .gsb, QIF or CSV.

WARNING: QIF and CSV file formats do not support currency, and all transactions will be converted to the currency of their respective account.

To export an archive, follow these steps:

1. in the menu bar, select *File - Export an archive as GSB/QIF/CSV file*: the archive export wizard window is displayed; confirm with the *Following* button;
2. a table displays the list of existing archives with their names and, where applicable, their initial and final dates, their financial year or the name of the report; select the archive to be exported by ticking the box in its row; confirm by clicking the *Following* button.
3. a file manager window will appear; you can modify:
   - the name of the file under which the archive will be exported,
   - the folder where it will be saved,
   - the format of the export file between Grisbi (GSB), QIF or CSV formats.
     Note: the QIF format only accepts one file per account; Grisbi will therefore create as many QIF files as there are accounts.

   Confirm by clicking the *Following* button;
4. the last window informs you that the archive has been exported; confirm by clicking the *Close* button.

7 Account management

Grisbi can manage four types of accounts, the use of which is described in detail in the section 7.8 on page 53, *Grisbi account types*:

- bank account: it allows you to perform any type of operation;
- cash account: it only allows you to manage cash;
- liability account: it allows you to manage a debt that you are repaying;
- asset account: it allows you to manage an asset that depreciates over time.

7.1 List of accounts

To list the accounts, first expand the *Accounts* tab in the navigation panel by clicking on the small triangle to its left. The navigation panel displays the list of accounts, which you can scroll through by clicking successively on one of the two small triangles on the left in the information bar.

Note: depending on the theme of your desktop environment or window manager, these triangles can be replaced with other characters such as +, -, >, <, etc.

You can change the display order of accounts in the navigation pane by clicking on an account name and dragging it up or down in the list of accounts in the navigation panel.

7.2 Selecting an account

To select and display the contents of an account, use one of the following methods:

- click on its name in the navigation panel;
- move the selection with the keyboard keys ↑, ↓;
- in the information bar, click on one of the two small triangles on the left to scroll through the accounts.

Note: depending on the theme of your desktop environment or window manager, these triangles can be replaced with other characters such as +, -, >, <, etc.

The navigation panel displays the name of the selected account on a dark pink background; the information bar displays the account name on the left and the account balance on the far right; the details panel displays two tabs by default:

- the *Transactions* tab, which contains the list of transactions (see the chapter 8 on page 60 Account transactions);
- the *Properties* tab.

The details panel can also display, if the budget module has been activated for the selected account, other tabs that are not described in this chapter (see the chapter **??** on page ??, *Provisional Budgets*):

- either the *Forecasts* and *Historical data* tabs for bank or cash accounts;
- either the *Amortisation table* tab for liability accounts.

Some accounts may be closed, so they are hidden from view. However, you can display them by selecting the menu *View - Show closed accounts*. To reverse this operation, see the section 7.3, *Account properties*.

7.3 Account properties

The *Properties* tab allows you to enter and display information about the selected account (fig. 7.1).

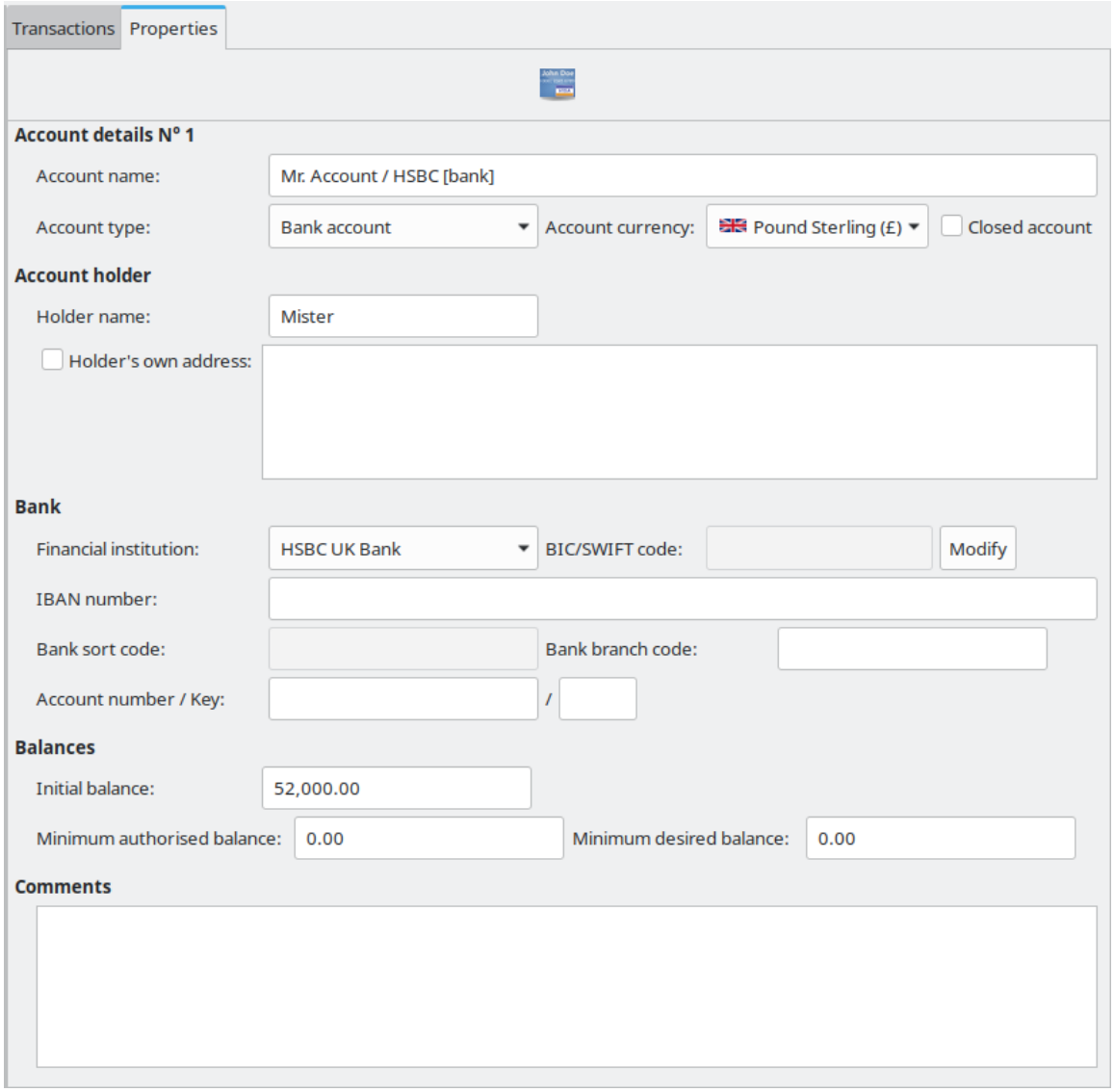

Figure 7.1: Account *Properties* tab

To view the properties of an account, select it and then click the *Properties* tab in the details panel. This tab displays all the information and properties that have already been entered for the selected account. To modify this data, see the section 7.5 on page 52, *Modify an account*.

The various pieces of information that an account may contain are divided into five sections:

1. *Account details No. x*:
   - *Account name*: this can be any name, for example *Current account*, *Bank account 1* or *Bank account 2*;
   - *Account type*: for more details, see section 7.8 on page 53;
   - *Account currency*: the currency in which transactions for this account are denominated (see sections **??** on page ?? and **??** on page ??);
   - *Closed account*: checkbox that allows you to hide the account in the navigation panel and in the information bar, without deleting it; it can be displayed again by clicking on the *View - Show closed accounts* menu;

2. *Account holder*:
   - *Account holder name*: the account holder may be different for each account, for example if you open a savings account for each of your children;
   - *Address of the holder*: the holder may have the same address as the main holder, or a different address, which must be specified here after ticking the box *Holder's own address* (see paragraph **??** on page ??, *Addresses*);

3. *Bank*:
   - *Financial institution*: the bank that manages your account; you can choose a bank from the drop-down list, or click on *Add a new bank*; it is advisable to fill in this field (see section **??** on page ??);
   - *BIC/SWIFT code*: after selecting an existing bank, you can click on the *Modify* button to open a window for editing the bank's settings;
   - *IBAN number*: the code found on your bank account details (BBAN) or IBAN provided by the bank (see section **??** on page ??);
   - *Bank sort code*: displays the code of the financial institution selected above;
   - *Bank branch code*: the address of your bank branch, which can also be found on your bank account details (see the section **??** on page ??);
   - *Account number / Key*: see your bank details (see section **??** on page ??);

4. *Balances*:
   - *Initial balance*: the balance of your last bank statement at the time the account was created; it is advisable to leave the opening balance of the account at zero and then create an initial transaction for the required amount, as this will facilitate future reconciliation management;
   - *Minimum authorised balance*: the minimum balance authorised by your financial institution, more commonly known as an overdraft facility;
   - *Minimum desired balance*: the minimum balance you would like to maintain; for the balance colour coding on the *Home* page to work properly, it must be greater than or equal to the minimum authorised balance;

5. *Comments*: input field for informal comments on the account: opening date, rate of return, etc. (see section **??** on page ??).

7.4 Creating a new account

Note: before you start creating a new account, it is advisable to consult the section 7.8 on page 53, *Grisbi account types*, and the section **??** on page ??, *Payment methods*, which provide much more detail about the options available in Grisbi.

You can create a new account in two ways:

- either by clicking on the menu *Edit - New Account* (or with Ctrl + Shift + N);
- either by right-clicking in the navigation panel, on the *Accounts* tab or on an existing account, and clicking *New account* in the context menu.

The *Create a new account* wizard, consisting of four steps, opens:

1. welcome screen (step 1/4); confirm by clicking the *Next* button;
2. *Select account type* (fig. 7.2) (step 2/4):

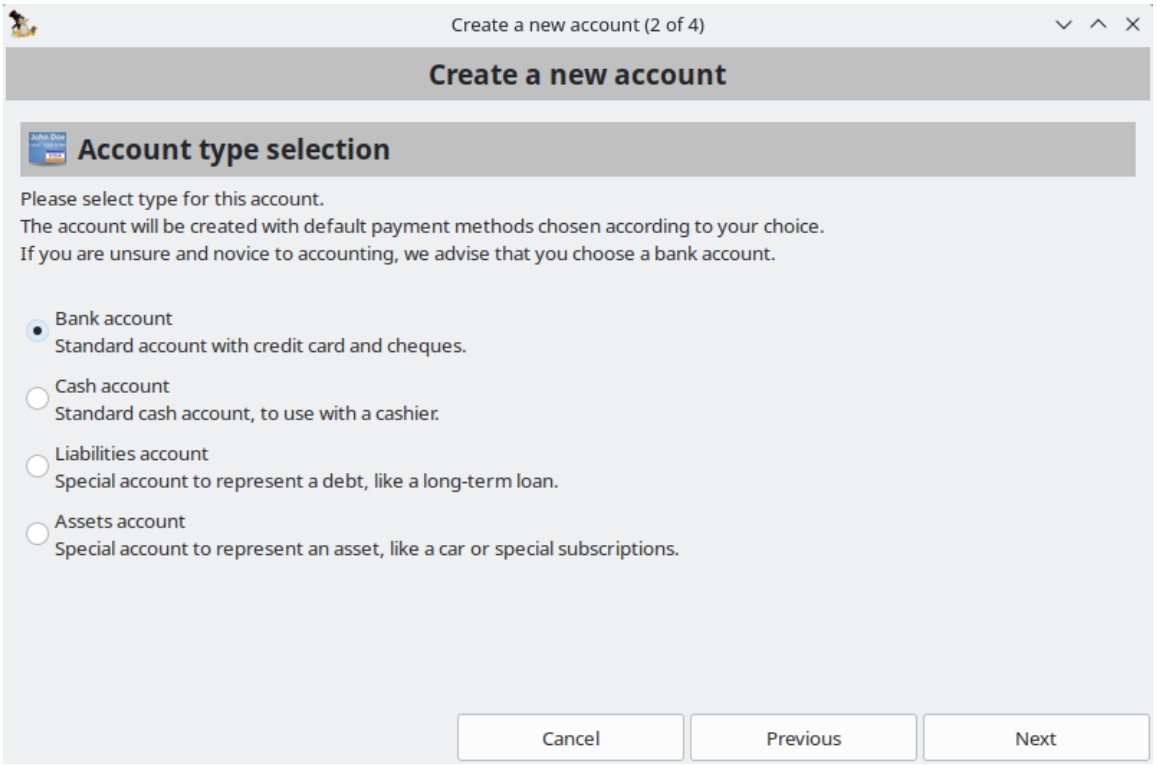

Figure 7.2: Choice of new account type

Choose from the four types of accounts available, then confirm by clicking the *Next* button. **Note**: when creating a new account, be careful to choose the correct account type, otherwise you may later have to transfer all the transactions you have entered into it to a new, more appropriate account.

3. the following window allows you to configure this new account (fig. 7.3 on the facing page):
   a) select the account currency from the drop-down list, which contains the currencies already known to your Grisbi file; otherwise, click on *Add/Change...*, and a window will appear with a drop-down list containing all the currencies known to Grisbi; the

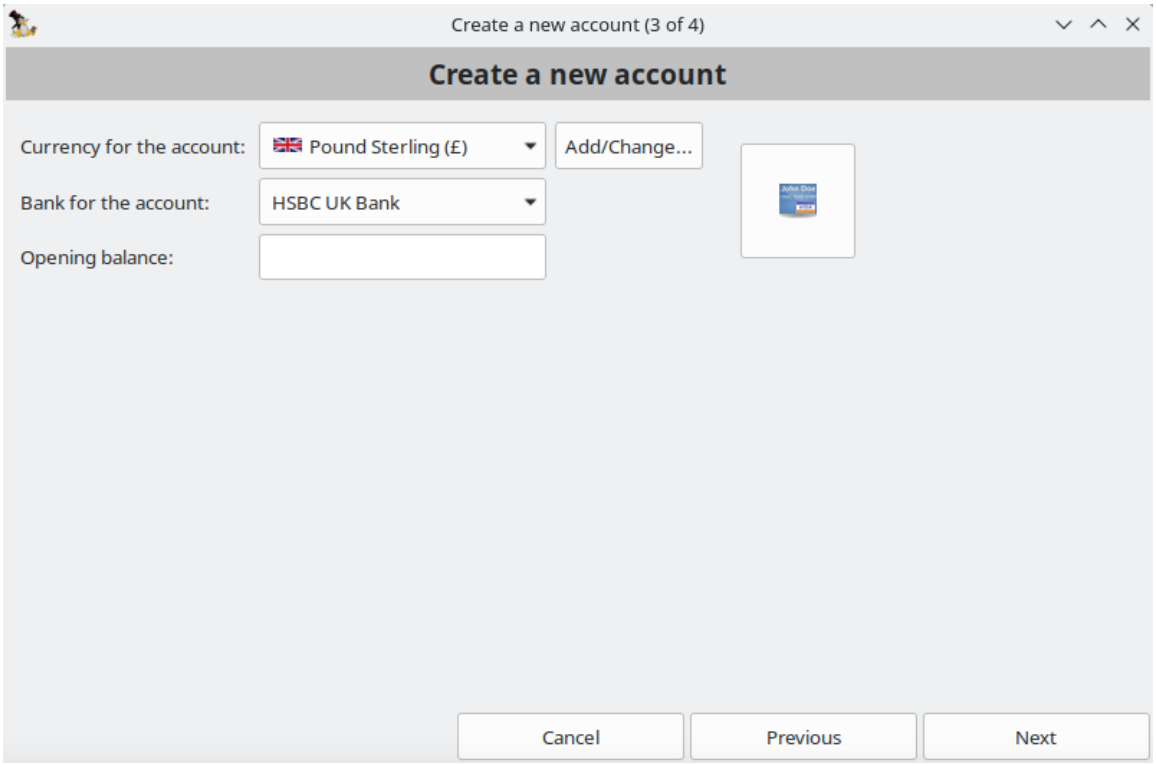

Figure 7.3: New account settings

details of the selected currency are displayed below, in fields that you can still modify; then confirm by clicking on the *Close* button.

b) select the bank that holds this account from the drop-down list, which shows the banks already known to your Grisbi file; otherwise, click on *Add new bank*: a window will appear where you can enter the name of the bank and many other details; then confirm by clicking on the *Apply* button.

c) enter the opening balance,

Note: it is advisable to leave the initial account balance at zero and, if necessary, to subsequently create an initial transaction for the required amount, as this will facilitate future reconciliation management.

d) select the icon for the account by clicking on it: a window will appear where you can either select a directory from the drop-down list and then click on one of the icons below, or search for a file in your computer's file system (using the *Browse* button). once you have found your icon, confirm by clicking on the *Validate* button,

e) then confirm your settings by clicking on the *Next* button.

4. the last window (fig. 7.4 on the next page) allows you to enter the name of the new account, which will appear in the navigation panel; then confirm by clicking the *Close* button.

5. the new account is then created and selected in the navigation panel: its name appears on a dark pink background, and the details panel displays the *Properties* tab, where you can modify or complete the settings; the *Transactions* tab is, of course, empty of any transactions.

If, and only if, you have just created your Grisbi file immediately prior to creating this account, return to the end of the section 3.3 on page 22, *Creating a new account file*. Go to the paragraph

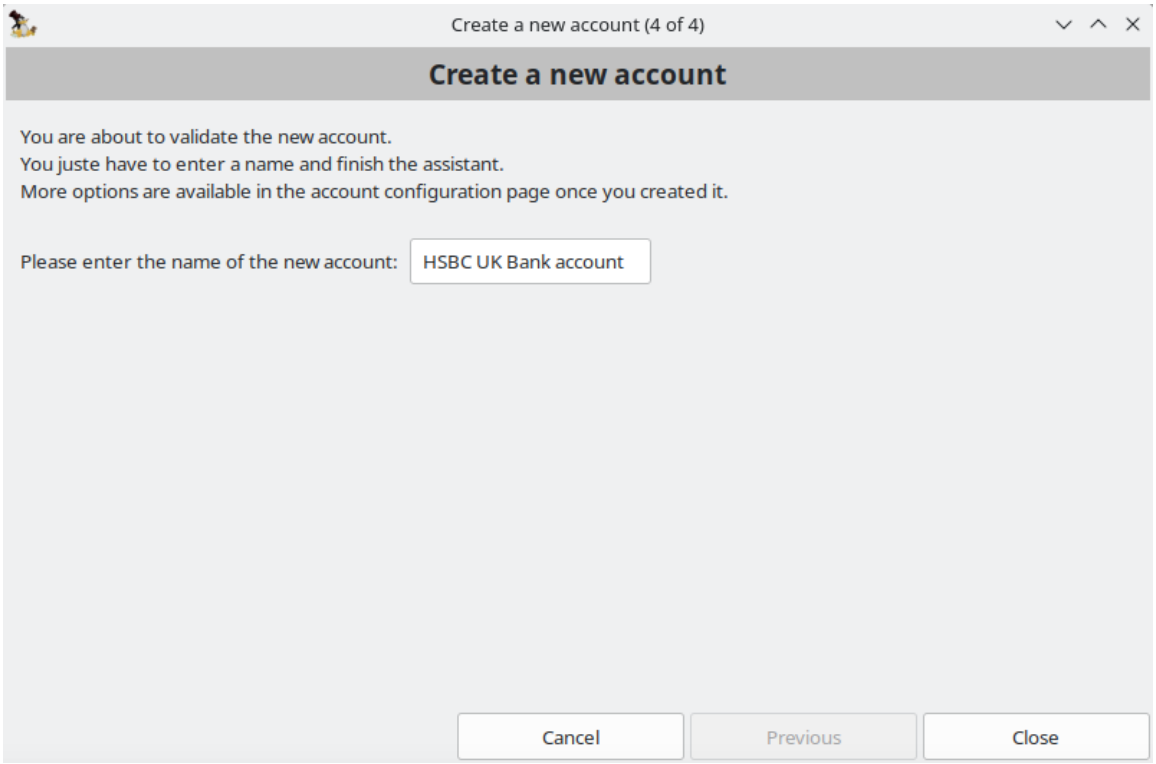

Figure 7.4: Entering the name of the new account

beginning with *One way or another...* , which will prompt you to create other accounts immediately.

Otherwise, you can start using the account you just created.

You can also configure the payment methods for this account in detail in the *Edit - Preferences* menu (see the **??** on page ?? section, *Payment methods*).

7.5 Editing an account

To edit an account, select the account in the navigation panel or using the information bar, then click the *Properties* (fig. 7.1 on page 48) tab in the details panel.

The following fields must be completed:

- section *Account details No. x*:
  - the *Account name*;
  - the *Account type*;
  - the *Account currency*;
- section *Balances*:
  - the *Initial balance*.

All other fields are optional.

You can change *all* of this information at any time.

The fields *Account type*, *Account currency*, *Financial institution* provide access to a drop-down list that can be used to fill in the field.

The white text fields (as opposed to the grey fields) can be filled in using the keyboard, and a context menu accessible by right-clicking in an input field allows you to perform the following actions:

- *Cut* (the selection);
- *Copy* (the selection);
- *Paste* (the selection);
- *Delete* (the selection);
- *Select all* in the field provided;
- *Insert emoji*: opens a window giving access to all kinds of emoticons and icons.

WARNING: If you change certain properties such as the account type, you will need to adapt all operations already entered to the new account properties *individually*. In any case, before making any changes to the accounts, you **must** back up your account file.

7.6 Closing an account

This allows you to hide an account without deleting it (see the procedure in the *Account properties*7.3 on page 48, paragraph 1. *Account details No. x*, option *Closed account*).

7.7 Deleting an account

There are two ways to delete an account:

- either by selecting an account, with the *Operations* tab displayed in the details panel, then clicking on the *Edit - Remove current account* menu in the menu bar,
- either by right-clicking on an account in the navigation panel, which opens a context menu giving access to the *Remove this account* option.

A confirmation dialogue box will open; if this is what you want, confirm the deletion by clicking the *Yes* button.

WARNING: there will be no further warning, and the account, along with all its transactions, will be deleted. This action is **irreversible**!

Translation note: the following sections are translations from the French manual and are not transposed into Anglo-Saxon accounting. Furthermore, the author does not have Anglo-Saxon linguistic and accounting skills. Therefore, the accuracy of the examples and terms used cannot be guaranteed.
A proofreader would be most welcome.

7.8 Types of Grisbi accounts

As stated at the beginning of this chapter, Grisbi can manage four types of accounts:

- bank account: it allows you to perform all types of transactions (see 7.8.1 on the following page);

- cash account: it only allows you to manage cash (see 7.8.2 on page 57);
- liability account: this allows you to manage a debt that you are repaying (see 7.8.3 on page 57);
- asset account: this allows you to manage an asset that depreciates over time (see 7.8.4 on page 58).

This section describes the features and usage of each of these account types.

7.8.1 Type *bank account*

The account type *bank account* allows all types of transactions, whether debit or credit. Therefore, it must be used for all of the following accounts:

- bank account or current account;
- savings account;
- account for debit bank card;
- credit card account;
- suspense account;
- advance account.

The following paragraphs describe these accounts, which must use the account type *bank account*.

7.8.1.1 Bank account, current account, savings account or debit card account

These accounts are used to record all the transactions you can carry out with your bank:

- account-to-account transfer;
- debit from the account;
- issuing and depositing cheques;
- purchase, refund, withdrawal and deposit with an debit bank card.

7.8.1.2 Credit card account

A credit card account is a bank card account that can receive debits as well as credits, either in the form of transfers or loans (e.g. revolving credit). Its balance can therefore be positive or negative.

7.8.1.3 Suspense account

A suspense account is used to record transactions (usually receipts) pending transfer to a bank or cash account. It is normally credited until the transfer to the bank or cash account, which brings it back to a zero balance.

The deposit of cheques and the deposit of cash are typical examples of the usefulness of the suspense account.

Delivery of cheques or cash: If you receive few cheques or cash, the simplest thing to do is to enter them directly into your bank account (or cash account). In this case, refer to the section 8.6.7 on page 70, *Depositing cheques or cash*.

However, if you receive a large number of cheques (for example, because you manage an association and your members pay their membership fees by cheque), the most efficient solution is to use a suspense account.

The method therefore consists of creating a *suspense account*, which you could name, for example, *Cheques to be cashed*. As you receive cheques, you record them individually in this account, with each cheque corresponding to a *Payee*. When you deposit the cheques at the bank, you make a transfer from this *Cheques to be cashed* account to your bank account for the total amount of these cheques, i.e. the balance of the *Cheques to be cashed* account. Create a payee called *Cheque Deposit*, select *Transfer* as the *method of payment* and enter the number of your deposit slip in the *Cheque/Transfer Number* field.

The balance of the *Cheques to be cashed* account is then reset to zero, and the bank account is credited with the amount of the deposit, exactly as it will appear on your bank statement. This allows you to keep track of both the third-party information for each cheque and the overall deposit information.

You then perform a pseudo-reconciliation of the *Cheques to be cashed* account by simulating a zero balance statement before the next cheque is received: check that this reconciliation has a number, or give it one, for example DEP-01, which will allow you to later find which cheque was part of which deposit.

For example, if you have received two cheques, you record two transactions in your *Cheques to be cashed* account:

Date	*Payee*	*Credit*	*Categories*	*Method of payment*
12/02/2024	Smith	£20.00	Contributions	*Cheque*
12/04/2024	Jones	£40.00	Contributions	*Cheque*

Puis lors de la remise des deux chèques à la banque, dans votre compte bancaire, vous enregistrez l'opération:

Date	*Payee*	*Credit*	*Categories*	*Mode de règlement*
12/15/2024	Cheque deposit	£60.00	*Transfer:* Cheques to be cashed	*Cheque*

Note: you can record this transaction either in your bank account under *Credit* and *Category*: *Transfer: Cheques to be cashed*, or in your *Cheques to be cashed* account under *Debit* and *Category*: *Transfer: Bank account*; in both cases, Grisbi automatically creates the counter-transaction in the other account.

Note: you can add payment methods, both debit and credit, that are not natively included in Grisbi (e.g. Cash, Documentary collection, etc.) as you see fit. This can be done in the Grisbi preferences (see the section **??** on page ??).

The *Cheques to be cashed* account is then balanced at zero, but it keeps track of the cheques deposited at the bank, and only the total amount of the deposit slip appears in your bank account, which you can check against your bank statement.

Of course, if some of your members pay you in cash, you can use an account named, for example, *Cash deposits* in the same way.

7.8.1.4 Advance account

An advance account is used to record both advances you receive and advances you grant. These may include, for example, an advance on your salary or a purchase you make on behalf of a friend.

Note: the advances account can be confusing for beginners, as it works in reverse, as you will discover later. To make things easier, you can think of the advances account as a third party who gives you money or to whom you give money.

Receipt of an advance: when you receive an advance, you record the transaction by transferring funds from the advances account to a bank account. The payee will be the person or organisation from whom you receive the advance, and the category will be *Transfer: Bank account*. In the *Notes* field, you indicate the reason for the advance. The advances account is therefore in debit when you owe money. When you repay this advance, you make a transfer from the bank account, with the same payee and the same note, to the advances account, whose balance returns to zero.

For a cash advance, replace the bank account with a cash account.

If the advance is paid to you by cheque, and if you have created a *Cheques to be cashed* suspense account, you must first record the cheque in the advances account, then transfer the amount of the cheque from the advances account to this *Cheques to be cashed* account, and then make your cheque deposit transfer from this *Cheques to be cashed* account to your bank account (see the paragraph 7.8.1.3 on page 54, *Suspense account*).

You will then reconcile the advances account to remove these transactions.

Consent to an advance: conversely, if you consent an advance, you record the transaction as a transfer from a bank account to the advances account. The payee will be the person or organisation to whom you are granting the advance, and the category will be *Transfer: Advances account*. In the *Notes* field, you will indicate the reason for the advance. The advance account is therefore credited when you are owed money. When this advance is repaid to you, you record the transaction by transferring the amount from the advance account to the bank account, with the same payee and the same note, and the category will be *Transfer*: *Bank account*. The balance of your advances account will then return to zero.

For a cash advance, replace the bank account with a cash account.

If the advance is reimbursed to you by cheque, and if you have created a *Cheques to be cashed* suspense account, you must first record the cheque in the advances account, then transfer the amount of the cheque from the advances account to this *Cheques to be cashed* account, and then make your cheque deposit transfer from this *Cheques to be cashed* account to your bank account (see the paragraph 7.8.1.3 on page 54, *Suspense account*).

You will then reconcile the advances account to remove these transactions.

An advance account therefore allows you to easily check whether your receivables or payables have been settled. Without this method, such verification is difficult, if not impossible.

Note: when you draw up a report of incomes and outgoings, these transactions should be transparent, as they cancel each other out when each advance is repaid. In practice, when editing this type of report, you will need to configure it so that it does not take into account transfers

between accounts, and thus these transactions will be completely invisible (see the section **??** on page ??, *Transfers*).

Note: when creating a new account, it is best to choose the *bank account* account type, unless your new account is to be used for a more specific purpose, such as those described in the paragraphs below.

7.8.2 Type *cash account*

The *cash account* account type is intended solely for transactions settled in cash; you cannot select a payment method for it, and it cannot become negative under any circumstances. As a result, it must be used for all of the following accounts:

- cash account;
- electronic wallet.

A cash account allows you to record bank withdrawals to replenish the cash register, as well as cash receipts and outgoings, in your accounts. When it comes to expenses, it is not always possible or even useful to record every small expense. However, you can record them collectively, for example at the end of the month, in appropriate categories or in a category called *Miscellaneous expenses*, in order to clear this cash account. This way, you will not have any discrepancies in the cash account.

A cash account accepts transfers from other accounts. When you make a cash withdrawal from your bank account, record it as a transfer to the cash account.

7.8.3 Type *liability account*

The account type *liability account* is an account that represents a debt, for example a loan. Therefore, it must be used for all of the following accounts:

- loan account;
- account of a deferred debit card.

7.8.3.1 Loan account

A loan account is used to manage a loan. Its initial balance is zero, but as soon as you take on debt, it becomes negative by the amount of that debt, and then increases with each repayment made, returning to zero after the final repayment.

In practice, the initial balance of this account is zero, but it becomes (heavily) negative as soon as the first transaction takes place, namely the transfer of the loan amount from the credit institution to your current account. At this point, you record a transfer from the liability account to this current account, which allows you to proceed with your purchase.

For example, when the credit institution Ameri Credit pays you £20,000.00 to buy a car costing £25,000.00 from Auto Matic, you create a liability account called *Loan*, and in this account, you enter the following transaction:

Date	*Payee*	*Credit*	*Categories*	*Notes*
06/01/2025	Ameri Credit	£20,000.00	*Transfer*: *Bank Ruptcy*	Debt borrowed Ameri Credit

Note: if this transfer is made directly by the credit institution to the seller's account, the category should be, for example, *Transfer: Fixed Asset Account*; you may have only one fixed asset account for all your assets, or one account per asset purchased.

Each time you make a payment on your loan, you record a transfer from your current account to the *Loan* account for the amount of the principal repaid, in the category *Transfer: Loan*, and an expense on this current account for the amount of interest in the category *Financial expenses: Loan charges*. If applicable, add an expense for insurance in the category *Insurance*. This way, you will always know the amount of capital remaining to be repaid, as well as the cost of the loan.

For example, at each due date, you enter a breakdown transaction (more information in the chapter 8.9 on page 74) on your current account to obtain a transaction like this:

- Parent transaction:

Date	*Payee*	*Debit*	*Categories*
07/01/2025	Ameri Credit	£350.00	*Split of transaction*

○ 1st child transaction:	£300.00	*Transfer*: *Bank Ruptcy*
○ 2nd child transaction:	£48.80	*Financial expenses*: *Borrowing costs*
○ 3rd child transaction:	£ 1.20	*Insurances*

Remember that if the repayment amount remains constant, within each subsequent repayment period, the amount of capital repaid increases and the amount of interest paid decreases (see the loan amortization table).

You can therefore use a liability account to manage your loans. As Grisbi does not currently offer automatic breakdown of loan repayments (amortization, interest and fees automatically carried over from your amortization table), you can still enter a planned and broken down transaction for repayments, either manually or automatically, and adjust the amounts at each due date according to your amortization table (see the section **??** on page ??, *Amortization table*).

When a liability account is balanced, meaning that you have repaid the corresponding debt, Grisbi notifies you by displaying a message at the bottom of the details panel on the home page (see the chapter 4.2 on page 25, Home).

7.8.3.2 Deferred debit card account

Deferred debit cards can be managed in various ways, but it is preferable to manage them in a specific account, which will be a liability account, since their balance cannot be positive. You will find all the details you need to manage these bank cards correctly in the section **??** on page ??, *Deferred debit bank card*.

7.8.4 Type *asset account*

The *asset account* account type is an account that represents an asset, such as a car. Its initial balance is zero, but it becomes positive as soon as you own the asset, in an amount equal to its value, then decreases over time as it depreciates, eventually reaching a value of zero. Transactions are carried out by transfer. It can be considered the opposite of a liability account.

In practice, the initial balance of this account is zero, but it becomes (highly) positive as soon as the first transaction takes place, namely the purchase of this asset. At that point, you record a transfer from your current account to this asset account, equal to the purchase price of the asset, which allows you to proceed with your purchase.

For example, when you purchase a car worth £25,000 from Auto Matic, you create an asset account called *Fixed Assets*, and in your current account, you enter the following transaction:

Date	*Payee*	*Debit*	*Categories*	*Notes*
06/01/2024	Auto Matic	£25,000.00	*Transfer*: Fixed Assets	Car purchase asset

Your *Fixed Assets* account therefore records a credit transaction for the amount of this car.

Whenever you notice a depreciation of this asset, you record a withdrawal from the asset account for the amount of the depreciation in the *Depreciation: Devaluation* category. These withdrawals may be made until the account balance is zero. This way, you will always know the value of your asset.

For example, after one year, the value of your car has decreased; in your *Fixed Assets* account, you enter the following transaction:

Date	*Payee*	*Debit*	*Categories*
06/01/2025	Car depreciation	£5,000.00	Depreciation: Devaluation

When you make a purchase, the amount you actually own is your personal contribution. Over time, you repay your loan in monthly instalments, while your property declines in value. The balance of your asset and liability accounts will give you the total amount you own at any given time.

8 Account transactions

The various accounts you have created contain transactions. To view the list of accounts stored in your accounts file, use the information bar or the navigation panel (see the 4.2 on page 25, *Home* chapter and the 7.1 on page 47, *Account List* section).

To view the transactions for an account, select that account from the list: the *Transactions* tab (fig. 8.1) will appear by default. It contains four main sections:

1. the toolbar (section 8.1 on the facing page);
2. the list of transactions (section 8.2 on the next page);
3. the transaction entry form (section 8.3 on page 65);
4. the reconciled balance (section 8.4 on page 67).

Note: if you have never carried out a reconciliation – i.e. you have not performed any reconciliation entries – Grisbi cannot calculate or display a reconciled balance.

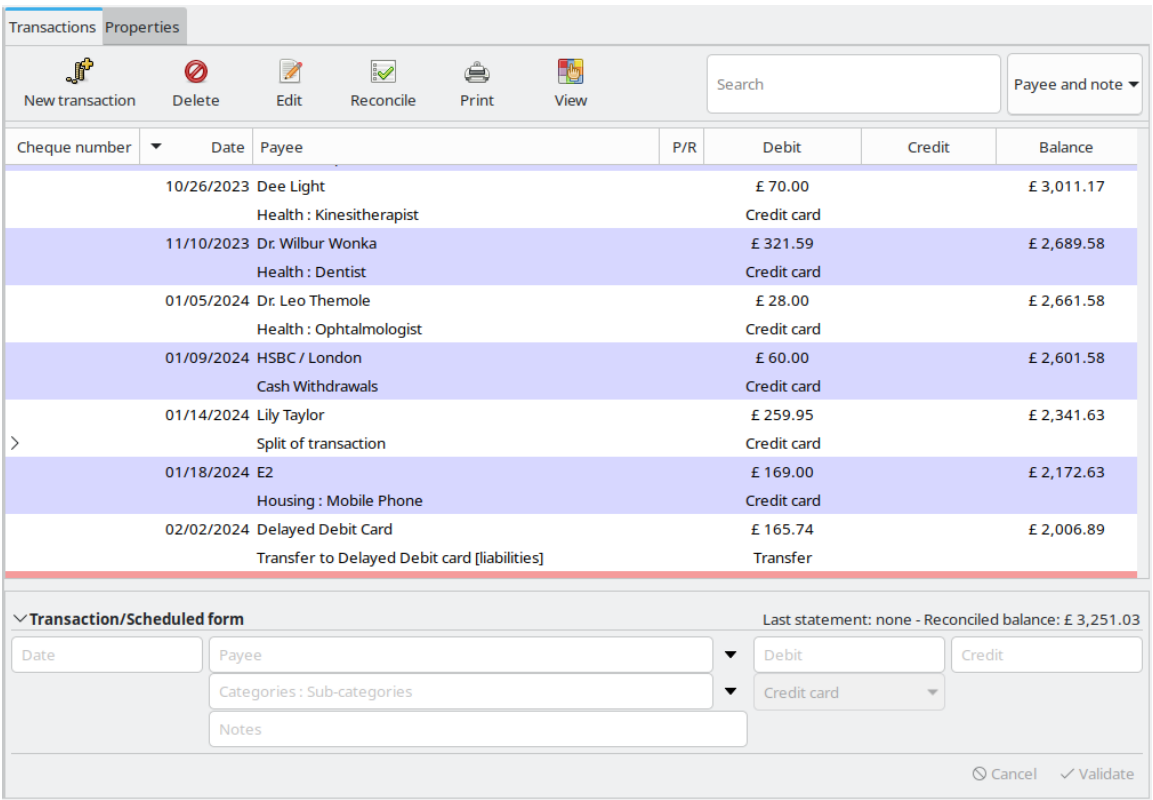

Figure 8.1: The *Transactions* tab of an account

8.1 Toolbar

The toolbar is located at the top of the details panel and offers the following functions:

- *New transaction*: goes to the end of the list of transactions and opens a blank entry form;
- *Delete*: deletes the selected transaction;
- *Edit*: opens the input form for the selected transaction and allows you to edit it;
- *Reconcile*: opens the reconciliation page for the selected account (see the section **??** on page ??, *Bank reconciliation*);
- *Print*: opens the window for selecting the printer and its options;
- *View*: opens a drop-down menu; you can choose the view of transactions from four options:
  - *Simple view*,
  - *Two lines view*,
  - *Three lines view*,
  - *Complete view*,

  as well as:
  - whether or not to show reconciled operations,
  - whether or not to show the archives lines (6.3.2 on page 45).

  Note: the options in the *View* menu affect the display of all accounts by default. You may prefer a different display for each account; this can be configured in the *Edit - Preferences - Transactions - List Behaviour* menu (see the section **??** on page ??, *Account Differentiation*).
- a *Search* box, which must contain at least three characters,
- a drop-down list on the right that allows you to filter the displayed operations by:
  - the *Payee name*,
  - the *Note*,
  - the *Payee and note* (selected by default),
  - the *Budgetary line*,
  - the *Category*.

  Note: the search is case-insensitive and must include at least three (3) alphanumeric characters; it displays only the matching operations in the list of operations. The search is performed ONLY on the displayed operations (note whether or not the reconciled operations are shown) and does not include the archives.

8.2 List of transactions

8.2.1 Description

The list of transactions is displayed in the details panel (fig. 8.1 on the preceding page) below the toolbar.

The column header bar is displayed at the top. You can widen or narrow a column by clicking on the separator between two columns and dragging it. To restore the columns to their default width, select *View - Reset the column width* from the menu bar.

You can scroll the list of transactions up or down using the mouse wheel, or by dragging the vertical scroll bar. To scroll left or right, use the mouse to drag the horizontal scroll bar.

You can choose whether or not to display:

- the reconciled transactions by selecting:
  - in the menu bar *View - Show reconciled transactions* (Alt + R) (see the section 4.6.3 on page 31),
  - in the toolbar *View - Show reconciled Transactions* (section 8.1 on the previous page);
- the lines archives (see the section *Archives display* 6.3.2 on page 45):
  - in the menu bar *View - Show lines archives* (Alt + L) (see the section 4.6.3 on page 31),
  - in the toolbar *View - Show lines archives* (section 8.1 on the preceding page).

From the perspective of the Grisbi database, a transaction consists of its information fields. The information fields for each transaction are displayed in the various cells defined by the intersection of rows and columns. There can be a maximum of four rows and seven columns, which defines a maximum of twenty-eight information fields for each transaction.

Each transaction can be displayed over 1, 2, 3 or 4 lines, depending on the selected display mode (see the 4.6.3 on page 31 section, the *View* menu in the menu bar, or the *View* function in the 8.1 on the preceding page, *Toolbar* section). The current display is indicated by a tick.

You can also configure the content of these lines, as well as the saving of display settings, individually for each account, in the *Edit - Preferences - Transactions* (see the sections **??** on page ??, *List behavior* and **??** on page ??, *Transactions list cells*).

The column label is always the name of the information field displayed in the first row of the transactions.

To improve the readability of the display, Grisbi does not show any borders around cells, columns, rows or transactions, but instead uses alternating colours of purple background and white for each line.

8.2.2 Information and input fields

Grisbi can manage, for each transaction, a complete list of information fields and input fields, which are as follows:

- *Date* of the transaction: date on which the transaction took place; this can be used to calculate balances;
- *Value date*: date on which the bank records the transaction; this is the date used for calculating interest and fees; it may be used to calculate balances;
- *Payee*;
- *Budgetary line*;
- *Debit*: amount debited from the account balance; in the case of transactions in a different currency from that of the account, the transaction amount in the different currency;
- *Credit*;
- *Balance*: an amount always calculated *after* the operation displayed on the same line; it depends chronologically on the selected primary sort; a negative balance is displayed in red;
- *Amount*: for transactions in a different currency from that of the account, the transaction amount in the account's currency;
- *Method of payment*;

- *Reconciliation reference*: the number of each reconciliation entry in each account;
- *Financial year*;
- *Category*;
- *P/R*: transaction status, *P (Pointed)* or *R (Reconciled)*;
- *Voucher*, for example the invoice number (*Voucher* and *Transaction number* are cross-references that ensure the traceability of the transaction);
- *Notes*: any relevant information about the transaction;
- *Bank references*, only relevant if you are recording a cheque you have received;
- *Transaction number*: this is a unique serial number that Grisbi assigns to each transaction; you can transfer this number to the corresponding voucher (*Transaction number* and *Voucher* are cross-references that ensure the transaction can be traced);
- *Cheque number* or *Cheque/Transfer number*, if the selected payment method allows this information to be entered;
- *Currency* of the transaction;
- *Change* corresponding to the exchange rate;
- Contra-transaction *method of payment*: you can configure this for each account in the *Edit - Preferences - Resources* menu (see the section **??** on page ??, *Payment methods*);
- *Automatic/Manual*: status of a scheduled transaction's execution.

The list of transactions and the transaction/scheduled form each use a subset of these fields. You can view the two complete lists in the tables under the *Edit - Preferences* menu:

- section *Transactions - Transactions list cells* (see section **??** on page ?? *Cells in the transaction list*);
- section *Transaction Form - Content* (see section **??** on page ?? *Content*).

8.2.3 Management of information fields

By default, Grisbi displays a number of these fields (payee, category, debit, etc.) in the transaction list. However, you can also manage the information fields differently, i.e. display new fields, modify them or hide them, as you see fit. You can either carry out these actions in the *Edit - Preferences - Transactions - Transactions list cells*, which provides a complete overview of the layout of fields within the cells and allows you to make several changes easily (see the section **??** on page ??, *Transactions list cells*), or do so directly in the transaction list, using the methods below:

8.2.3.1 Adding an information field

To add an information field to a cell, do the following:

1. select *View - Complete view* from the toolbar, or *View - Show four lines per transaction* from the menu bar, to ensure that you can see all twenty-eight cells;
2. `right-click` in one of the empty cells in the column where you want to add this field: be precise, as there is no way of telling which cell you have clicked on;

3. a context menu will appear; select *Change cell content*; check that there is no information field already in this cell by ensuring that none of the fields in the drop-down list has a tick to the left of its name;
4. select an information field from the list; this field will be added to the selected cell, and all transactions in the list will display it.

8.2.3.2 Editing an information field

To edit an information field in a cell, do the following:

1. select *View - Complete view* from the toolbar, or *View - Show four lines per transaction* from the menu bar, to ensure that you can see all twenty-eight cells;
2. `right-click` in one of the empty cells in the column where you want to modify this field: be precise, as there is no way of telling which cell you have clicked on;
3. a context menu will appear; select *Change cell content*; the current information field in this cell is indicated by a tick to the left of its name;
4. select another field from the list; this field will replace the previous one in the selected cell, and all transactions in the list will display it.

8.2.3.3 Deleting an information field

To delete an information field in a cell, do the following:

1. select *View - Complete view* from the toolbar, or *View - Show four lines per transaction* from the menu bar, to ensure that you can see all twenty-eight cells;
2. `right-click` in the cell of the field you want to delete: be sure to do this carefully, as there is no way of telling which cell you have clicked on;
3. a context menu will appear; select *Change cell content*; the current information field in this cell is indicated by a tick to the left of its name;
4. select *Clear Cell* from the list; the current information field will disappear for all operations in the list (but the information will not be deleted from your accounts file under any circumstances).

8.2.3.4 Moving an information field

To move an information field, you can delete it and then add it to another empty field, but you can also do this via the *Edit - Preferences - Transactions - Transactions list cells* (see the section **??** on page ??, *Transactions list cells*).

8.2.4 Sorts

To change the order in which transactions are displayed, you can sort the transactions by one of the information fields; proceed as follows:

1. `right-click` on the column header containing the field selected as the sorting criterion;
2. a context menu displays a list of the fields in that column; select the field you wish to use as the sort criterion;

3. all transactions are displayed, sorted according to the selected criterion;
4. a small black triangle appears to the right or left of the column heading; it points downwards if the sort is ascending, and upwards if it is descending;
   Note: depending on the theme of your desktop environment or the window manager you are using, these triangles can be replaced with other characters such as +, -, >, <, etc.
5. click on this triangle to change the sort order.

Note: sorting the display in this way does not affect the balance for each line, which is calculated after each transaction; depending on the sort order and display options you have chosen, the balance for each line may not appear in chronological order.

You can also configure the general sort order in the *Edit - Preferences* menu (see the section **??** on page ??, *Transaction list behavior*).

Note: the choice of the primary sorting criterion (transaction date or value date) that may have been selected there will necessarily affect the balance displayed on each transaction line, as Grisbi calculates and displays the balance on each line.

8.3 Transaction/Scheduled entry form

The entry form is located below the list of transactions (fig. 8.2).

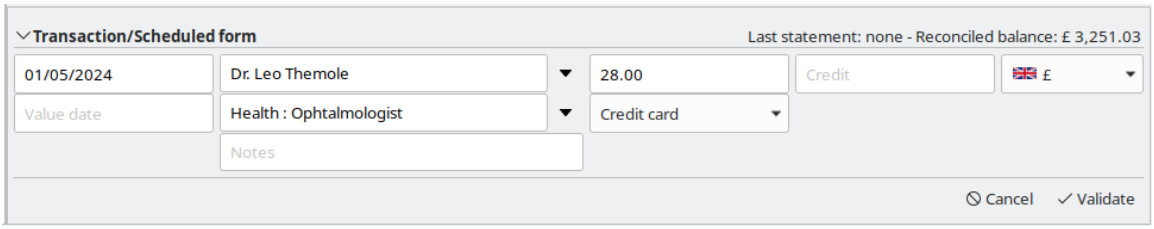

Figure 8.2: Customised transaction entry form

8.3.1 Form visibility

The form can be hidden or displayed as required.

8.3.1.1 Displaying the form

To open or display the entry form, use one of the following methods:

- in the menu bar, select *Edit - New transaction* if an account is selected;
- in the menu bar, select *View* and tick the box next to the *Show transaction form* option;
- select the blank line at the bottom of the list of transactions and press the Enter key;
- double-click on the empty line at the bottom of the list of transactions;
- press the Ctrl + T key combination;
- in the toolbar, click on *New transaction*;

- in the context menu of the transaction list, select *New transaction*;
- click on the small triangle next to the label show/hide on the transaction entry form to the left of the label.

  Note: depending on the theme of your desktop environment or the window manager you are using, these triangles can be replaced with other characters such as +, -, >, <, etc.

The last line, which is completely blank, at the bottom of the list of operations, appears in dark pink background, and the blank input form is displayed, showing only the current date, or the last date entered, in white on a blue background.

8.3.1.2 Hiding the form

To hide the entry form, use one of the following methods:

- in the menu bar, select *View* and uncheck the box next to the *Show transaction form* option;
- click on the small triangle next to the label show/hide on the transaction entry form to the left of the label.

  Note: depending on the theme of your desktop environment or the window manager you are using, these triangles can be replaced with other characters such as +, -, >, <, etc.

8.3.2 Form contents

The entry form includes the following seven fields by default:

- *Date* of the operation,
- *Payee*,
- *Debit*,
- *Credit*,
- *Categories* : *Sub-categories*,
- *Method of payment*
- *Notes*

You may need additional fields, such as *Financial year*, *Budgetary line* or others; this is done in the form content settings. There are two ways to access them:

- either by `right-click` in the entry form, in a grey area outside the entry fields, and then clicking the *Configure the form* button (see the section **??** on page ??, *Transaction Form - Content*),
- or by going to the *Edit - Preferences - Transaction Form - Content* menu to edit the fields as you wish.

For a full list of the fields that Grisbi can handle, see the section 8.2.2 on page 62, *Information and entry fields*

Once the form is displayed, a context menu that can be accessed by `right-click` in an entry field allows you to perform the following actions:

- *Cut* (selection);
- *Copy* (selection);
- *Paste* ()selection;
- *Delete* (selection);

then

- *Select All* (in the entry field);
- *Insert Emoji*.

8.4 Pointed balance

Below the list of transactions, on the same line as the label *Transaction/Scheduled form*, two pieces of information are displayed on the right:

- the date of the last reconciled bank statement,
- the reconciled balance corresponding to this latest reconciliation, unless you reconcile your transactions very regularly, in which case it corresponds to the balance as recorded by your bank (see the chapter **??** on page ??, *Bank reconciliation*).

8.5 Selecting an transaction

There are two ways to select an transaction:

- click on one of its lines;
- move the selection using the ↑ and ↓ keys.

The transaction then appears in dark pink background and its details are displayed in the form.

`Right-click` on a transaction line displays a context menu containing the following functions, depending on the context (fig. 8.3):

- *Displays the contra-transaction*: this option is only available if the transaction is a transfer;
- *Edit transaction*;
- *New transaction*;
- *Delete transaction*;
- *Use selected transaction as a template*;
- *Clone transaction*;
- *Convert transaction to scheduled transaction*: this makes it easy to create due dates retrospectively;
- *Move transaction to another account*;
- *Search* (see the chapter **??** on page ??);
- *Change cell content*.

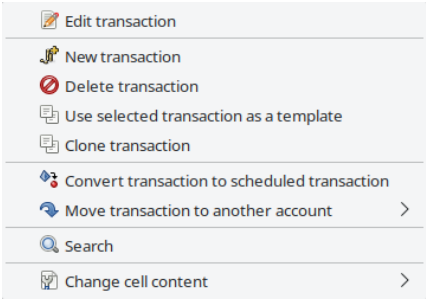

Fig. 8.3
Context menu for an transaction

8.6 Entering a new transaction

Transactions are entered using the entry form (section 8.3 on page 65), located below the list of transactions.

8.6.1 Entering information

Enter the relevant details about your transaction in the various fields of the form. Some fields can be filled in either using the keyboard or via a drop-down list. If you use the keyboard, your entry will be automatically saved in the drop-down list for that field. If you wish, you can always remove this selection from the list later: refer to the various sections dealing with these lists (*Payee*, *Categories*, *Budgetary lines* and the various tabs in the *Resources* section of the *Edit - Preferences* menu.

Each entry field must be filled in with the appropriate data type (date, number, text); otherwise, the incorrect data will turn red.

Once the last field in the form has been filled in and submitted, the transaction appears in the list of transactions, and the active line, highlighted in dark pink background, moves to the last empty line in the list.

The following subsections describe the various input methods available.

8.6.2 Main keyboard commands

The Tab key allows you to navigate within the form.

The Enter key can be used either to move around the entry form or to submit the entry; this can be configured in the *Edit - Preferences - Transaction form* menu (see the **??** on page ?? section, *Form behavior*). This setting applies to both the Enter key on the alphabetic keyboard and the one on the numeric keypad.

The Esc key cancels the current entry.

8.6.3 Entering the date using the keyboard

The current date or the last date entered is displayed automatically when the form is opened.

You can enter the date in one of the following formats:

- mm/dd/yy (with a separator between the month, day and year);
- mmddyy or mmdd (without delimiters); in this case, you must use two digits for the month, day and year;
- m/d/y if the month, day or year consists of a single digit (e.g. 1/1/1 for January 1st, 2001).

Furthermore, there is no need to enter the year if it is the same as the current year, or the month if it is the current month, as Grisbi will fill these in automatically.

Finally, you can increase or decrease the displayed date:

- per day using the + or - keys;
- per week using the Shift + + or Shift + - keys;
- per month using the PageUp or PageDown keys;
- per year using the key combinations Shift + PageUp or Shift + PageDown.

8.6.4 Entering a date in the calendar

Double-clicking on the date, or pressing the Ctrl + Enter key combination, brings up a calendar from which you can select the date.

You can then select a new date using the mouse or keyboard:

- the + or - keys, as well as the ← or → keys, allow you to move to the previous or next day;
- the ↑ or ↓ keys allow you to move to the previous or next week;
- the PageUp or PageDown keys allow you to move to the previous or next month;
- the Home or End keys allow you to move to the first or last day of the month;
- clicking the *Cancel* button or pressing the Esc key closes the calendar without changing the date;
- double-clicking or pressing the Enter key confirms the selected date.

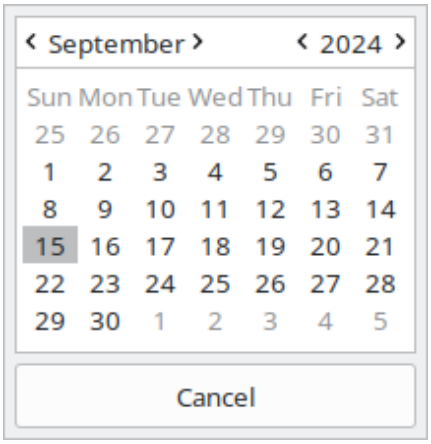

Fig. 8.4
Calendar

8.6.5 Drop-down lists

Some fields have a drop-down list of predefined options. You can select an option using the mouse, or you can type the data into the entry field using the keyboard.

You can open a drop-down list by clicking the small triangle to the right of the field with the mouse, or by pressing the PagegDown or ↓ keys on the keyboard; to navigate through the list, you can use:

- the mouse and the scrollbar to the right of the list,
- the mouse wheel,
- the PageUp, PageDown, ↑ or ↓ keys,

Note: depending on the theme of your desktop environment or the window manager you are using, these triangles can be replaced with other characters such as +, -, >, <, etc.

Grisbi will suggest automatically completing the word you have entered as soon as it has recognised enough characters. The selected auto-complete appears on blue background. To confirm your choice, press the Tab key or the Enter key, depending on your configuration settings; otherwise, continue typing.

The drop-down lists for currencies, financial years and methods of payment can be opened using the Space key or a `left-click` of the mouse; you can navigate through them using the ↑ and ↓ keys, and confirm your selection using the Space key, the Enter key or a `left-click` of the mouse.

8.6.6 Entering formulas

In the entry form, you can enter numbers, with or without decimals, into fields such as *Debit* and *Credit* using the keyboard.

You can also enter simple arithmetic expressions using the four basic arithmetic operators: addition, subtraction, multiplication and division. This replaces the calculator on your desk.

To enter an arithmetic formula, type it as if it were text, for example “3.40-2.10”, then continue entering the other fields of your transaction as normal; if it is entered incorrectly, it will be displayed in red. When you click the *Validate* button and for a new transaction, the result “1.30” appears in the list of transactions; otherwise, the result also appears in the entry field. And if the formula is still incorrect, the message “###ERR###” will appear instead and you will not be able to validate the financial transaction.

Warning: please use only the period as a decimal point and the comma as a thousands separator; otherwise, this will cause calculation errors (e.g., "1,2+2.4=14.40"). For your information, with Grisbi in other languages (French, German, etc.), the period and comma are interchangeable as decimal separators.

This calculator accepts the multiplication or division, but in a manner exclusive of addition or subtraction; that is to say that we can mix additions and subtractions in an entry but not a multiplication (or division) and any other operator: we cannot put parentheses to indicate an order of priority of operation.

This feature can be very useful, particularly for adjusting the amounts of a split transaction in the event of a discrepancy.

8.6.7 Depositing cheques or cash

To record a cheque deposit, first deposit the cheques into your bank account at the bank, which will give you a deposit slip, then enter the deposit transaction as a credit to your bank account.

To record a cash deposit, you must first deposit the cash either into your bank account at the bank, which will issue you with a deposit slip, or into your cash box, and then enter the deposit transaction as a credit to your cash account.

If you receive a lot of cheques (for example, because you run a charity and your members pay their membership fees by cheque), you have two options:

- either you record each cheque as a separate transaction in your bank account, and then bundle these cheques together to deposit them at the bank; your deposit slip will then show only the total amount; when reconciling your bank account, your bank statement will show only this total amount, but not the amount of each cheque entered into your bank account; as a result, reconciliation becomes rather difficult (you should at least have made a list of these cheques beforehand);
- either you record a single transaction for all your cheques, in which case you will have lost the third-party details for each cheque, and this information will not appear in the *Payee* tab, even if you try to split this transaction.

If none of these methods suit you, a better solution is to use a *suspense account*. The procedure for doing so is explained in detail in the section 7.8.1.3 on page 55, *Delivery of cheques or cash*.

8.6.8 Transfers

The term transfer covers two different concepts: external transfers and internal transfers. Here are the recommended entry methods for each case.

8.6.8.1 External transfers

External transfers are transfers made by your bank, or by you if you place an order online, to or from your account. They can be incoming (e.g. if your employer instructs your bank to transfer your salary to you) or outgoing (e.g. if you instruct your bank to make a SWIFT transfer to pay a bill abroad).

This is a type of transaction similar to a cheque, and you can enter it by selecting *Payment of method*: *Transfer* in the entry form.

8.6.8.2 Internal transfers

The internal transfers are transfers between your various Grisbi accounts, which do not necessarily have an equivalent in the bank; here are some examples:

- if you use a cash account, when you make a cash withdrawal at the bank, you enter a transfer to that cash account in Grisbi, but the transaction type is a *Withdrawal*;
- if you use an advance account, when you issue or receive a refund check, you enter an internal transfer, even though the type of transaction is *Check*;
- if you use a liability account to manage a loan, you enter the monthly direct debit made by your bank as an internal transfer from your bank account to your liability account, as a *Direct debit*;
- if you use a bank account for a deferred debit card, you enter the monthly withdrawal by your bank as a transfer from your current account to this card account.

However, if you do not use any of these accounts and your account file contains only a current account and a savings account, then internal transfers will be transfers from one account to the other. These will indeed be transactions of the *Transfer* type, and you should record them in the *Transfer*: *Savings account* or *Transfer*: *Current account* category, as appropriate.

You can make transfers between accounts by selecting the category *Transfer: the_account_to_be_charged*. Depending on whether you enter the amount under *Debit* or *Credit*, this will be a transfer *to the account* or a transfer *from the account*. Of course, both accounts must be in the same file created by Grisbi.

If you make a transfer between two accounts in different currencies, Grisbi will automatically carry out the conversion, and the debit and credit will clearly show the currencies; for example, if, in your yen account, you make a transfer transaction in credit from an pound sterling account, the transfer will appear in yen in the *Credit* column, and its yen balance will be correct. In the pound sterling account, the debit amount will appear in yen in the *Debit* column, and in pound sterling in parentheses, in the *Amount* (8.2.2 on page 62) field in the *Credit* column (by default), if the display is at least in *Two lines view* (see notes below).

Note: to display the *Amount* field, you will need to configure the transaction list by:

- checking/adding the *Amount* field (see the section **??** on page ??, *Transaction list cells* or the section 8.2.3 on page 63, *Management of information fields*),
- adjusting the number of lines displayed in the transaction list (see the section 8.1 on page 61 *Toolbar* or the section 4.6.3 on page 31 *View Menu*).

Note: if you display an existing transaction in the entry form, you should configure the form's content by adding the *Currency* field to view the currency associated with the debit or credit transaction (see the **??** on page ?? section, *Content*).

8.6.8.3 Contra-transaction of a transfer

When you enter a transaction of the type "internal transfer" - from one account to another, or from one account to another - Grisbi automatically creates the contra-transaction in the other account, i.e. the corresponding transfer in the recipient account or the source account.

If the transfer is in a foreign currency, it will automatically create the contra-transaction entry in the currency of the destination account if the exchange rate is fixed; otherwise, it will ask you to confirm this before posting the entry.

To view the contra-transaction for a transfer, `right-click` on its line in one of the two accounts, and in the context menu, select *Displays the contra-transaction*: the other account is displayed and the transaction is selected (on dark pink background). If you repeat exactly the same action in that same account, the original account and its transfer are displayed again.

8.6.9 Advances: consent and receipt

You may need to consent to or receipt an advance of funds: this could be, for example, an advance on your salary or a purchase you make on behalf of a friend.

There are two ways to handle this:

- the simplest approach is to create a dedicated category and assign debit and credit transactions to it; once all advances have been repaid, the balance of this category, as shown in the list of categories, should be zero (see the section **??** on page ??, *List of categories and sub-categories*);
- a more useful approach is to create an advance account, which provides a more immediate overview of the status of outstanding advances: this is described in detail in the section 7.8.1.4 on page 56, *Advance Account*.

8.6.10 Automatic form completion

The automatic completion of a transaction, if you have enabled the *Automatic filling transactions from payee* option (under the *Edit - Preferences - Transaction form - Completion*), allows you to enter a transaction assigned to a payee already known to your Grisbi file much more quickly: when entering the payee, as soon as you leave the input field, the other fields in the form are automatically filled in to match the last transaction entered for that payee. It is up to you to modify them if necessary before confirming the transaction.

You can fine-tune this behaviour in the *Preferences* menu (see the section **??** on page ??, *Form completion*).

Note: if you do not change any fields and confirm the transaction, you will simply end up with a duplicate transaction, but one dated today.

8.7 Entering a currency transaction

Grisbi can handle transactions entered in a different currency from that of the account, with or without exchange fees.

To use a different currency, you must first carry out the following settings:

1. create the currency, if it has not already been created, via the *Edit - Preferences - Resources* menu (see the **??** on page ?? section, *Currencies*);

2. in the following menu, create the link(s) you need between the new currency and the others already saved (see the section **??** on page ??, *Currencies links*);
3. configure the display of the *Currency* field in the transaction form (see the **??** on page ?? section, *Content*);
   Note: the *Currency* and *Change* fields are linked in the data entry form: configuring the display of the *Currency* field in the form automatically positions the *Change* field in the same place, and vice versa; you can then move them to the desired cells.
4. configure the display of the *Amount* field in the transaction list (see the section **??** on page ??, *Transactions list cells* or the section 8.2.3 on page 63, *Management of information fields*).

When entering the currency transaction in the entry form, select the currency in which the transaction is to be recorded from the drop-down list. Several questions may arise:

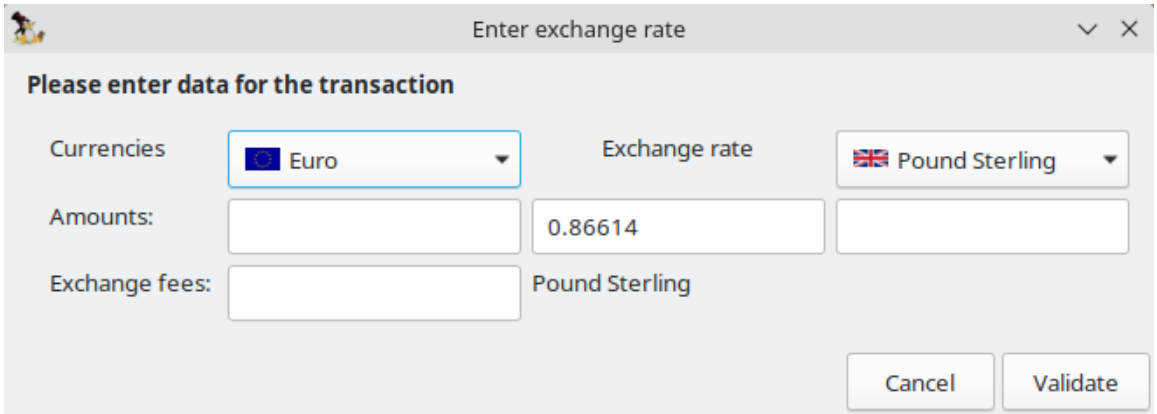

Figure 8.5: Fees and exchange rates

- if you have not created a link (exchange rate) for this currency, Grisbi displays the fees and exchange rates window (fig. 8.5): enter the exchange rate there, confirm the window, then confirm the transaction: the amount in the currency is displayed in the *Debit* field and the amount in the account's currency in the *Amount* field;
  Note: you can reverse the direction of the conversion (one pound sterling is worth X Currency, or one Currency is worth Y pounds sterling) by swapping the names of the currencies in the two drop-down lists; this allows you to enter the exchange rate exactly as it has been provided to you; this rate can be adjusted at any time after the transaction has been created.
- if you wish to change the exchange rate, open the transaction for editing, click the *Change* button in the input form, tick the *Change the link* checkbox if it is not already ticked, then change the rate, and save the window and the transaction;
- if you have any exchange fees, open the transaction in edit mode, click the *Change* button in the entry form, enter the fees in the account's currency in the *Exchange fees* field, and confirm the window and then the transaction; These fees are then added to the contents of the *Amount* field; however, you can instead enter them in a separate transaction, using a dedicated category, for example *Financial expenses: Bank charges*: this allows you to record them separately;
- if you want the exchange rate to be fixed: see the section **??** on page ??, *Currencies links*.

8.8 Entering a transaction with a virtual third party

Grisbi allows you to use virtual third parties: a virtual third party is a *report* that represents a list of several third parties.

When you enter a transaction with a virtual third party as the payee, Grisbi records, upon validation, an identical transaction (amount, category, budgetary line, payment method, etc.) for *each* of the third parties represented by that virtual third party. For example, you can enter a membership fee request for 200 members of an association in a single go, which saves a considerable amount of time. . .

To enter a transaction with a virtual third party, proceed as follows:

- enter this third party in the *Payee* field of the entry form, in the format "Report : name_of_virtual_third_party";
  Note: please ensure you follow the syntax correctly, with a space before AND after the ":".
- create a virtual third party by creating a report of type *Blank report* containing a list of payees: see the section **??** on page ??, *Virtual Third Party*;
- modify the virtual third party as required by editing the report that created it: see the section **??** on page ??, *Modifying a report*.

To delete a virtual third party, you have two options:

- uncheck the *Consider the payees of this report as a multiple payee* box in the *General* section of the report that defines it, then click on the *Validate* button (see the section **??** on page ??,
- delete the report that defines it (see the section **??** on page ??, *Deleting a report*).

8.9 Breakdown of a transaction

Break down a transaction means to split the amount across several lines (for example, your supermarket purchases can be split between the categories *Food : Groceries* and *Personal care : Clothing*). You can also split a sum within the same category, but with different information in the *Notes* field (for example, to record the details of a transaction).

Note: please ensure you follow the syntax correctly, leaving a space before AND after the ":" between the category and a new sub-category.

8.9.1 Entering the breaken-down transaction

To enter a breaken-down transaction, proceed as follows:

1. in the form, start entering your transaction as you would for a normal transaction until you reach the *Categories* field, where you should select the *Split Transaction* category (towards the end of the drop-down menu, but it's easier to type the letters "sp");
2. continue entering the remaining details, then validate:
3. the following appear in the list of transactions:
   - the first line of the new operation is written in red and is therefore highlighted; it will remain in red as long as the total of the sub-transactions differs from the amount of the transaction;

- and below that, a new line, with dark pink background, with a total of zero and a difference equal to the difference between this total and the total value of the split transaction, i.e. a negative figure (fig. 8.6);

03/15/2024	C-store Lily Taylor	£ 259.95
	Split of transaction	Credit card
	Total: £ 0.00 (variance: £ -259.95)	

Figure 8.6: Entering the split transaction

4. in the entry form, the cursor is in the *Debit* field, and the *Date*, *Payee* and *Payment method* fields are greyed out, meaning they can no longer be edited: this is the sub-transaction form, which is ready for entering sub-transactions;
5. go to the next subsection *Entering split sub-transactions*.

8.9.2 Entering split sub-transactions

Note: the amount of a sub-transaction may be the result of a transaction involving several purchases or expenses listed on a receipt or invoice; you can therefore use the calculator in the *Debit* or *Credit* input fields to more easily obtain the amounts of sub-transactions (see the section 8.6.6 on page 69, *Entering formulas*).

To enter split sub-transactions, continue typing as follows:

1. in this sub-operation form, fill in the empty fields (those not greyed out), then save your first sub-operation;

03/15/2024	C-store Lily Taylor	£ 259.95
	Split of transaction	Credit card
	Food : Grocery	£ 112.51
	Total: £ -112.51 (variance: £ -147.44)	

Figure 8.7: Entering the first split sub-transaction

2. in the list of operations, this sub-transaction is displayed on pink background, and a new line appears, on dark pink background and is therefore selected, displaying a total equal to the first sub-transaction entered, in negative figures, and a difference equal to the difference between the total value of the split transaction and the value of this sub-transaction, in negative form (fig. 8.7);
3. there are at least two sub-transactions in a split transaction (otherwise there is no point in doing it. . .); therefore, in the sub-transaction form, enter a second sub-transaction in the same way, then click on *Validate*: this sub-transaction appears on pink background and a new line appears, on dark pink background and is therefore selected, displaying the latest total of the sub-transactions entered and the latest difference (fig. 8.8); the total of the sub-transactions has increased (negatively) by the amount of this second sub-transaction, whilst the difference has decreased (negatively) by the same amount;

03/15/2024	C-store Lily Taylor	£ 259.95
	Split of transaction	Credit card
	Food : Grocery	£ 112.51
	Food : Wines & Spirits	£ 95.49
	Total: £ -208.00 (variance: £ -51.95)	

Figure 8.8: Entering the second split sub-transaction

4. if the difference is not zero, a third sub-transaction can then be entered in the same way (fig. 8.9),

03/15/2024	C-store Lily Taylor	£ 259.95	£ 1,746.94
	Split of transaction	Credit card	
	Food : Grocery	£ 112.51	
	Food : Wines & Spirits	£ 95.49	
	Leisures : Books	£ 22.99	
	Total: £ -230.99 (variance: £ -28.96)		

Figure 8.9: Entering the third split sub-transaction

5. and so on until the amount you have entered for your last sub-transaction in the form is exactly equal to the difference shown.
   Note: until the transaction is complete, it remains displayed in red.

8.9.3 Validation of the split transaction

Once this final sub-operation has been validated, your split transaction will appear in the list of transactions just as a normal transaction would, and the active line, highlighted in dark pink background, will move to the last empty line in the list.

In the list of transactions, you will be able to identify your transaction by the presence of a triangle to the left of the first column (fig. 8.10).

03/15/2024	Lily Taylor	£ 259.95	£ 1,746.94
	Split of transaction	Credit card	

Figure 8.10: Split transaction in the list of transactions

8.9.4 Displaying the split transaction

By clicking on the triangle to the left of the split transaction, you select that transaction and view the details of its sub-transactions (fig. 8.11).

03/15/2024	Lily Taylor	£ 259.95	£ 1,746.94
	Split of transaction	Credit card	
	Food : Grocery	£ 112.51	
	Food : Wines & Spirits	£ 95.49	
	Leisures : Books	£ 22.99	
	Housing : Cleaning products	£ 28.96	

Figure 8.11: Full view of the split transaction

Note: depending on the theme of your desktop environment or the window manager you are using, these triangles can be replaced with other characters such as +, -, >, <, etc.

8.9.5 Automatic completion of the form for a split transaction

The automatic completion feature for a split transaction works in the same way as for a standard transaction (see the section 8.6.10 on page 72, *Automatic form completion*).

However, for a broken-down operation, a tick box labelled *Recover the children* appears at the bottom of the input form, to the left of the *Cancel* button, and you can tick this box as required.

8.10 Editing an transaction

To edit an transaction, a broken-down transaction, or one of its sub-transactions, select it from the list of transactions, where it will be displayed in dark pink background; it will also appear in the entry form, where you can select the desired fields by `left-click` and modify the values as you see fit.

If the entry form is hidden, do one of the following to display it:

- in the menu bar, select *Edit - New transaction* if an account is selected;
- in the menu bar, select *View* and tick the box next to the *Show transaction form* option;
- select the blank line at the bottom of the list of transactions and press the Enter ↵ key;
- double-click on the empty line at the bottom of the list of transactions;
- press the Ctrl + T key combination;
- in the toolbar, click on *New transaction*;
- in the context menu of the transaction list, select *New transaction*;
- click on the small triangle next to the label show/hide on the transaction entry form to the left of the label.

  Note: depending on the theme of your desktop environment or the window manager you are using, these triangles can be replaced with other characters such as +, -, >, <, etc.

When the process is complete, the date appears in white on a blue background in the form. You can then edit any information you wish by navigating through the entry fields.

The Ctrl + P key combination sets or clears the pointed transaction status for a selected transaction, and Ctrl + R sets or clears the reconciled transaction status (see the **??** on page ?? chapter, *Bank Reconciliation*). You can also assign a transaction the status of a pointed transaction—but only this status—by using the Ctrl + `Left Click` shortcut in the "P/R" column on the line of the transaction to be pointed.

If the transaction has already been reconciled (see the section **??** on page ??, *Bank reconciliation*), you cannot change its amount. The other fields remain editable.

If you absolutely must change the amount (though if you have already reconciled the transaction, this should not be necessary), proceed as follows:

1. select the transaction;
2. cancel its *Reconciled* status by pressing the Ctrl + R key combination;
3. change the amount;
4. press the Ctrl + R key combination again. The reconciliation for this transaction will then be distorted by an amount equal to the difference between the old and new amounts for this transaction;
5. you will then need to create a new transaction equal to the difference and reconcile it to ensure the reconciliation is accurate.

WARNING: undoing a reconciled transaction is strongly discouraged, as it temporarily distorts the reconciliation associated with that transaction; however, it will be restored to its correct state at the end, provided you have not altered the amount (this function will likely be disabled automatically in a future version of Grisbi for association-type accounting).

8.11 Deleting a transaction

To delete a transaction, select it, and use one of the following methods:

- press the Delete key on the keyboard;
- in the menu bar, select *Edit - Remove transaction*;
- in the toolbar, `left-click` on the *Delete* button;
- after `right-click`, select *Delete transaction* from the context menu.

Deleting a broken-down sub-transaction is done in the same way, and the broken-down transaction will turn red. You must therefore ensure that the sum of the sub-transactions ultimately equals the value of the broken-down transaction.

Deletion is not possible if:

- the transaction is open for editing: you must first exit edit mode by pressing the Esc key;
- the transaction is reconciled (you must first deselect its *Reconciled* status by pressing the Ctrl + R key combination).

Warning: this final step is strongly discouraged as it distorts the reconciliation associated with this transaction.

8.12 Transaction selected as a template

To use an transaction as a template, select it, and use one of the following methods:

- in the menu bar, select *Edit - Use selected transaction as a template*;
- after `right-clicking`, select *Use selected transaction as a template* from the context menu.

A new transaction with today's date is displayed in dark pink background, on a new line below the last transaction; naturally, it has neither the *Pointed* status nor the *Reconciled* status.

You can then edit this new transaction, for example by changing its date.

8.13 Cloning a transaction

To clone a transaction, select it, then use one of the following two methods:

- in the menu bar, select *Edit - Clone transaction*;
- after a `right-click`, select *Clone transaction* from the context menu.

A new transaction with the previously selected transaction date appears in dark pink background, and is displayed on a new line below the selected transaction; naturally, it has neither the *Pointed* status nor the *Reconciled* status.

You can then edit this new transaction, for example by changing its date.

8.14 Converting a transaction into a scheduled transaction

To convert an transaction into a scheduled transaction, select it, then use one of these two methods:

- in the menu bar, select *Edit - Convert transaction to scheduled transaction*;
- after `right-clicking`, select *Convert transaction to scheduled transaction* from the context menu.

The *Scheduler* tab opens. The new transaction appears in the list of scheduled transactions, and the entry form is displayed with the transaction settings. Check or edit these settings as required, then confirm.

8.15 Moving a transaction to another account

To move a transaction to another accounttransaction!move to another account, select it, then use one of these two methods:

- in the menu bar, select *Edit - Move transaction to another account* and choose the destination account from the list;
- after `right-clicking`, select *Move transaction to another account* from the context menu and choose the destination account from the list.

It goes without saying that both accounts must be in the same Grisbi created by file.

Note: It is not possible to move a transaction if it has the status *Reconciled*. However, it is possible if it has the status *Pointed*.

8.16 New payee, category or budgetary line

You may find that you need a new payee, a new category or a new budgetary line whilst entering a transaction. In this case, Grisbi allows you to create them "on the fly": simply enter the new name in the drop-down list, and Grisbi will automatically add it to the list. You can subsequently make any necessary changes in the *Payee* (see the section **??** on page ??, *Modifying a third party*), *Categories* (see the section **??** on page ??, *Modifying a category or sub-category*) or *Budgetary lines* (see the section **??** on page ??, *Modifying a* (*sub-*)*budgetary line*).

Note: to enter a category (or a budgetary line) with a sub-category (or sub-budgetary line), you must use the syntax *category : sub-category* (with a colon as the separator, flanked by spaces), otherwise Grisbi will not recognise it. The same applies if you add a new sub-category (or sub-budgetary line) to an existing category (or budgetary line).

You can also create a payee, a category or a budgetary line directly in their respective tabs, selected from the navigation panel.

8.17 Printing the list of transactions

To print the list of transactions, click the *Print* button on the toolbar; a print dialogue box will open, the appearance and functions of which depend on your printer driver; you will usually have the following options:

- print to a file (in PDF, PostScript, or SVG format);
- print to your printer.

Depending on your printer driver, you may have various settings available, such as paper size and orientation, resolution, font and font size, etc.

Note: the list of transactions for some accounts can be very long; view a print preview to check what you are about to print.

Index

A
account
    asset, 47
    bank, 47
    cash, 47
    closed, 48, 49
    liability, 47
account file, 18, 19
account types, 37
accounting entity, 19, 28
accounts file, 19
action
    irréversible, 53
addresses, 29
advance
    consent, 56, 72
    receipt, 72
alert
    scheduled entry, 29
archive
    delete, 46
    display, 45
    modification, 46
    number of transactions, 45
arithmetic expression
    entry field, 70
asset
    account, 59
    depreciation, 59
avance
    receive, 56

B
backup directory, 43
backup file
    compression, 43
    directory, 43
balance
    minimum authorised, 29
    minimum desired, 29
    negative, 62
    reconciled, 60, 67
bank
    creation, 51
banks
    definition, 21
break down
    transaction, 74
budgetary lines
    syntax, 79

C
calculator, 70, 75
card
    credit, 54
    debit, 54
    deferred debit, 57
categories
    syntax, 79
    types, 21
cell
    information field, 62
closed
    account, 32
column
    label, 62
    width, 61
compression
    backup file, 43
    file, 42
context menus, 27
Contra-transaction, 63
contra-transaction, 72
    display, 67
    view, 72
csv, 46
currency, 21
    different, 62, 71, 72
    transaction, 73
    transfer, 71

D
date
    transaction, 62
    value, 62

date format, 20
deposit
    cash, 54, 70
    cheque, 70
    cheques, 54
depreciation
    asset, 59
display, 29
    archives lines, 61
    full screen, 24
    lines archives, 62
    reconciled transactions, 62

E
emoji, 53, 67
encrypt
    file, 42
entry field
    arithmetic expression, 70
    auto-complete, 69
entry form
    display, 65
    hide, 66
ergonomics, 33
etymology, 2
exchange fees, 73
external transfer, 71

F
file
    compression, 42
    encrypt, 42
fonts, 29
form
    automatic completion, 72
full screen
    display, 24

G
generalities, 29
Grisbi, 2
group of accounts, 28
gsb, 46

H
home page, 28
HTML, 15, 17

I
icon, 51
information field
    add, 63
    definition, 62
    delete, 64
    edit, 64
    management, 63
    move, 64
information fields, 62
input fields, 62

L
loan, 57, 58
logo, 29

M
menu bar, 29

P
PDF, 15, 17, 32
porting, 7

Q
qif, 46

S
saving
    force, 42
scheduler, 29
separator, 20
show
    reconciled operations, 61
sort
    primary, 62
    transactions, 64
split transaction
    autofill, 76
sub-budgetary lines
    syntax, 79
subcategories
    syntax, 79
sub-transactions
    split, 75
SVG, 8, 12
syntax
    budgetary lines : sub-budgetary lines, 79
    categories : subcategories, 79

T
title, 29
title display
    title, 28
transaction

automatic completion, 72
breaken-down, 74
clone, 78
contra-transaction, 72
currency, 73
delete, 78
into a scheduled transaction, 79
orphan, 39
pointed, 77
reconciled, 77, 78
template, 78
transfer, 70
transaction form
show-hide, 66
transfer
contra-transaction, 72
currency, 71
internal, 71
types of accounts, 53

V
view
transactions, 61
virtual third party
transaction entry, 74

X
XML, 11, 19

Glossary

Note: most of the definitions in this glossary are taken from articles of the same name in the free, collaborative encyclopaedia *Wikipédia*[1]. Although these texts have been modified and adapted to the specific context of this glossary, the author would like to thank Wikipedia for providing these references.

C C is a general-purpose computer programming language which was originally developed by Dennis Ritchie between 1972 and 1973 to construct utilities running on Unix. Many later languages have borrowed directly or indirectly from C, including C++, C#, Unix's C shell, Java, Perl, PHP, and many others. 7

character encoding Character encoding is the process of assigning numbers to graphical characters, especially the written characters of human language, allowing them to be stored, transmitted, and transformed using digital computers. Common examples of character encoding systems include ASCII and Unicode UTF-8. 37

compression Data compression is the process of encoding information using fewer bits than the original representation. Typically, a device that performs data compression is referred to as an encoder, and one that performs the reversal of the process (decompression) as a decoder. 42, 43

CSV (*Comma-Separated Values*) is a text file format that uses commas to separate values, and newlines to separate records. 8, 11, 23, 30, 33, 36, 37, 40, 46

CVS (*Concurrent Versions System*) is a version control system originally developed by Dick Grune in July 1986. CVS operates as a front end to Revision Control System (RCS), an earlier system which operates on single files. It expands upon RCS by adding support for repository-level change tracking, and a client-server model. 12

Debian also known as Debian GNU/Linux, is a Linux distribution composed of free and open-source software and optionally non-free firmware or software developed by the community-supported Debian Project, which was established by Ian Murdock. Debian is also the basis for many other distributions that have different purposes, like Proxmox for servers, Ubuntu or Linux Mint for desktops, Kali for penetration testing, and Pardus and Astra for government use. The word "Debian" was formed as a portmanteau of the first name of his then-girlfriend (later ex-wife) Debra Lynn and his own first name. 13

extension This is a suffix to the name of a computer file. The extension indicates a characteristic of the file contents or its intended use. A filename extension is typically delimited from the rest of the filename with a period. For example, the readme.txt file is an plain text file. 19, 30, 36

[1] https://en.wikipedia.org/

file format A file format is a standard way that information is encoded for storage in a computer file. It specifies how bits are used to encode information in a digital storage medium. File formats may be either proprietary or free. One popular method used by many operating systems is to determine the format of a file based on the end of its name, more specifically the letters following the final period. This portion of the filename is known as the filename extension. 15, 36

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free software *Free software*, *libre software*, or *libreware* is computer software distributed under terms that allow users to run the software for any purpose as well as to study, change, and distribute it and any adapted versions.Un logiciel libre est un logiciel dont l'utilisation, l'étude, la modification et la duplication en vue de sa diffusion sont possibles techniquement et permises légalement. These rights are usually defined by a license. For instance, Grisbi is licensed under the *GPL* (*General Public License*). 17

Git is a distributed version control system that tracks changes in any set of computer files, usually used for coordinating work among programmers who are collaboratively developing source code during software development. Git was originally authored by Linus Torvalds in 2005 for development of the Linux kernel. Git is a free and open-source software shared under the GPL-2.0-only license. 9

GitHub is a proprietary developer platform that allows developers to create, store, manage, and share their code. It uses Git to provide distributed version control. It is commonly used to host open source software development projects. 9

Gnome originally an acronym for *GNU Network Object Model Environment*, is a free and open-source desktop environment for Linux and other Unix-like operating systems. 11

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GNU General Public License (*GNU GPL* or simply *GPL*) is a series of widely used free software licenses, or copyleft, that guarantee end users the four freedoms to run, study, share, and modify the software. The license was the first copyleft for general use, and was originally written by Richard Stallman, the founder of the *Free Software Foundation* (*FSF*), for the GNU Project. The last official GPLv3 was released by the FSF on 29 June 2007. 14

GNU/Linux *GNU*, initialy developed by Richard Stallman in 1984, is an extensive collection of free software, which can be used as an operating system or can be used in parts with other operating systems. GNU is a recursive acronym for "*GNU's Not UNIX*". The use of the completed GNU tools led to the family of operating systems popularly known as Linux. Linux is a family of open-source Unix-like operating systems based on the Linux kernel, an operating system kernel first released on September 17, 1991, by Linus Torvalds. Many

Linux distributions use the word "Linux" in their name, but the *Free Software Foundation* uses and recommends the name "GNU/Linux" to emphasize the use and importance of GNU software in many distributions. 7

Gnucash is an accounting program that implements a double-entry bookkeeping system. It was initially aimed at developing capabilities similar to Intuit, Inc.'s Quicken application, but also has features for small business accounting. Recent development has been focused on adapting to modern desktop support-library requirements. 8, 11, 23, 36, 39

Grisbi Grisbi is a free personal accounting program. 2

.gsb is the extension given to Grisbi account files. 30, 46

GTK (*formerly The GIMP Toolkit and GTK+*) is a free software cross-platform widget toolkit for creating Graphical User Interfaces (GUIs). 7, 11–13

HTML *HyperText Markup Language* or *HTML* is the standard markup language for documents designed to be displayed in a web browser. HTML provides a means to create structured documents by denoting structural semantics for text such as headings, paragraphs, lists, links, quotes, and other items. 11, 15, 17

hyperlinks In computing, a hyperlink, or simply a link, is a digital reference to data that the user can follow or be guided to by clicking or tapping. For instance, on the *World Wide Web* most hyperlinks cause the target document to replace the document being displayed, but some are marked to cause the target document to open in a new window (or, perhaps, in a new tab). 15, 17

IBAN *International Bank Account Number* uniquely identifies the account of a customer at a financial institution. 49

LaTeX is a software system for typesetting documents. LaTeX uses the TeX typesetting program for formatting its output, and is itself written in the TeX macro language. Its name comes from its author Leslie Lamport. 11, 13, 15

Linux see "GNU/Linux". 41

Linux distributions A Linux distribution, sometimes called a GNU/Linux distribution (often abbreviated as distro) is an operating system made from a software collection that includes the Linux kernel and often a package management system. Linux users usually obtain their operating system by downloading one of the Linux distributions, which are available for a wide variety of systems. 7

locale In computing, a locale is a set of parameters that defines the user's language, region and any special variant preferences that the user wants to see in their user interface. Usually a locale identifier consists of at least a language code and a country/region code. 37

macOS originally Mac OS X, previously shortened as OS X, is a partially proprietary operating system developed and marketed by Apple since 1998, whose macOS Tahoe (version 26) was launched on September 15, 2025 for the general public. 7

OFX *Open Financial Exchange* is a data-stream format for exchanging financial information (XML based) (that evolved from Microsoft's Open Financial Connectivity (OFC). 8, 11, 23, 36, 39

partition Disk partitioning is the creation of one or more regions on secondary storage, so that each region can be managed separately. These regions are called partitions. Each partition then appears to the operating system as a distinct "logical" disk that uses part of the actual disk. Partitioning allows the use of different filesystems to be installed for different kinds of files. The best known filesystems are FAT32, NTFS, Ext2, Ext3 and Ext4. 42

PDF *Portable Document Format* is a file format developed by Adobe in 1992 to present documents, including text formatting and images, in a manner independent of application software, hardware, and operating systems. 15, 17, 32, 80

porting In software engineering, porting is the process of adapting software for the purpose of achieving some form of execution in a computing environment that is different from the one that a given program (meant for such execution) was originally designed for. 7, 14

PostScript PostScript (often abbreviated as PS) is a page description language and dynamically typed, stack-based programming language. It is most commonly used in the electronic publishing and desktop publishing realm, but as a Turing complete programming language, it can be used for many other purposes as well. PostScript was created by Adobe Systems. 80

primary sorting is the term used in Grisbi to designate a sorting based on a primary sorting key, that is to say a first-level sorting. If there is only primary sorting without secondary sorting, it is a simple sorting, based on a single sorting criterion. 65

QIF *Quicken Interchange Format* is an open specification for reading and writing financial data to media. 8, 9, 11, 23, 30, 33, 36, 39, 40, 46

Red Hat Red Hat, Inc. (formerly Red Hat Software, Inc.) is an American software company that provides open source software products to enterprises and is a subsidiary of IBM. Red Hat creates, maintains, and contributes to many free software projects. 14

Slackware is a Linux distribution created by Patrick Volkerding in 1993. Originally based on Softlanding Linux System (SLS), Slackware has been the basis for many other Linux distributions, most notably the first versions of SUSE Linux distributions, and is the oldest distribution that is still maintained. Slackware aims for design stability and simplicity and to be the most "Unix-like" Linux distribution. 14

sorting In computer science, a sorting algorithm is an algorithm that puts elements of a list into an order. 64

SVG *Scalable Vector Graphics* is an XML-based vector image format for defining two-dimensional graphics, having support for interactivity and animation. 8, 12, 80

text editor A text editor is a type of computer program that edits plain text. Text editors are provided with operating systems and software development packages, and can be used to change files such as configuration files, documentation files and programming language source code. There are important differences between plain text (created and edited by text editors) and rich text (such as that created by word processors or desktop publishing software). Plain text exclusively consists of character representation. Plain text contains no other information about the text itself, not even the character encoding convention employed. Rich text, on the other hand, may contain metadata, character formatting data (e.g. typeface, size, weight and style), paragraph formatting data (e.g. indentation,

alignment, letter and word distribution, and space between lines or other paragraphs), and page specification data. 15

to encrypt In cryptography, encrypt a document is the process of encoding information. This process converts the original representation of the information, known as plaintext, into an alternative form known as ciphertext. Ideally, only authorized parties can decipher a ciphertext back to plaintext and access the original information. 20

UTF-8 is a variable-length character encoding standard used for electronic communication. Defined by the Unicode Standard, the name is derived from Unicode Transformation Format – 8-bit. It was designed for backward compatibility with ASCII, limited to 95 printable characters. 11

Windows is a range of proprietary operating systems developed by Microsoft. The first version of Windows, in 1985, was simply a graphical interface for MS-DOS used on IBM computers. Versions 2, 3, 95 (released in 1995 and sold pre-installed on almost all personal computers, due to the many exclusive agreements signed with computer manufacturers prohibiting them from installing another system on pain of financial penalties), XP, Vista, 7, 8 and 10 followed. Version 11 is the current version in 2025. 7, 20

XML *eXtensible Markup Language* is a markup language and file format for storing, transmitting, and reconstructing arbitrary data, inherited from SGML. 11, 19